

US Patent & Trademark Office

Patent Public Search | Text View

United States Patent	12414306
Kind Code	B2
Date of Patent	September 09, 2025
Inventor(s)	Sato; Noriyuki et al.

Method of fabricating memory devices using pocket integration

Abstract

A pocket integration for high density memory and logic applications and methods of fabrication are described. While various embodiments are described with reference to FeRAM, capacitive structures formed herein can be used for any application where a capacitor is desired. For example, the capacitive structure can be used for fabricating ferroelectric based or paraelectric based majority gate, minority gate, and/or threshold gate.

Inventors: Sato; Noriyuki (Hillsboro, OR), Gosavi; Tanay (Portland, OR), Mukherjee; Niloy (San Ramon, CA), Mathuriya; Amrita (Portland, OR), Dokania; Rajeev Kumar (Beaverton, OR), Manipatruni; Sasikanth (Portland, OR)

Applicant: Kepler Computing Inc. (San Francisco, CA)

Family ID: 85285802

Assignee: Kepler Computing Inc. (San Francisco, CA)

Appl. No.: 17/485147

Filed: September 24, 2021

Prior Publication Data

Document Identifier	Publication Date
US 20230077054 A1	Mar. 09, 2023

Related U.S. Application Data

continuation parent-doc US 17465792 20210902 US 12069866 child-doc US 17485147

Publication Classification

Int. Cl.: H10B53/30 (20230101); H01L21/768 (20060101); H01L23/528 (20060101);
H01L23/535 (20060101); H10B53/10 (20230101); H01L23/532 (20060101); H10D1/68
(20250101)

U.S. Cl.:

CPC H10B53/30 (20230201); H01L21/76802 (20130101); H01L23/528 (20130101);
H01L23/535 (20130101); H10B53/10 (20230201); H01L23/53209 (20130101);
H01L23/53228 (20130101); H01L23/53242 (20130101); H01L23/53257 (20130101);
H10D1/682 (20250101); H10D1/694 (20250101)

Field of Classification Search

CPC: H01L (21/76802); H01L (23/528); H01L (23/53228); H01L (28/60); H10B (53/10); H10B
(53/30); H10D (1/682); H10D (1/692); H10D (1/694)

References Cited

U.S. PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Issued Date	Patentee Name	U.S. Cl.	CPC
5705414	12/1997	Lustig	N/A	N/A
5739563	12/1997	Kawakubo et al.	N/A	N/A
6165864	12/1999	Shen et al.	N/A	N/A
6177351	12/2000	Beratan et al.	N/A	N/A
6211035	12/2000	Moise et al.	N/A	N/A
6365927	12/2001	Cuchiaro et al.	N/A	N/A
6368910	12/2001	Sheu et al.	N/A	N/A
6548343	12/2002	Summerfelt et al.	N/A	N/A
6613586	12/2002	Bailey	N/A	N/A
6699725	12/2003	Lee	N/A	N/A
6753193	12/2003	Kim	N/A	N/A
7075134	12/2005	Araujo et al.	N/A	N/A
7754501	12/2009	Urushido	N/A	N/A
7977720	12/2010	Fukada	N/A	N/A
8440508	12/2012	Udayakumar et al.	N/A	N/A
8916872	12/2013	Tran et al.	N/A	N/A
9847338	12/2016	Nakao	N/A	N/A
9875784	12/2017	Li et al.	N/A	N/A
10847201	12/2019	Manipatruni et al.	N/A	N/A
11043472	12/2020	Dokania et al.	N/A	N/A
11063131	12/2020	Haratipour et al.	N/A	N/A
11139270	12/2020	Manipatruni et al.	N/A	N/A
11164976	12/2020	Ramamoorthy et al.	N/A	N/A
11659714	12/2022	Mukherjee et al.	N/A	N/A
2001/0013614	12/2000	Joshi et al.	N/A	N/A
2002/0045279	12/2001	Kwon et al.	N/A	N/A
2002/0098645	12/2001	Jung et al.	N/A	N/A
2003/0030084	12/2002	Moise et al.	N/A	N/A

2003/0073252	12/2002	Park	257/E21.664	H10B 53/00
2005/0020054	12/2004	Hilliger et al.	N/A	N/A
2006/0133129	12/2005	Rodriguez et al.	N/A	N/A
2007/0045690	12/2006	Fukada	N/A	N/A
2007/0232016	12/2006	Hayashi et al.	N/A	N/A
2008/0057641	12/2007	Wang	N/A	N/A
2008/0121956	12/2007	Kanaya	N/A	N/A
2008/0121959	12/2007	Izumi	N/A	N/A
2008/0197502	12/2007	Kikuchi et al.	N/A	N/A
2009/0026514	12/2008	Wang	N/A	N/A
2009/0032978	12/2008	Bucchignano et al.	N/A	N/A
2010/0102404	12/2009	Li et al.	N/A	N/A
2010/0224961	12/2009	Summerfelt et al.	N/A	N/A
2010/0320518	12/2009	Ozaki	N/A	N/A
2011/0062550	12/2010	Udayakumar et al.	N/A	N/A
2013/0149794	12/2012	Wang	N/A	N/A
2013/0264620	12/2012	Yu et al.	N/A	N/A
2020/0051833	12/2019	Chen et al.	N/A	N/A
2020/0235111	12/2019	Calderoni et al.	N/A	N/A
2020/0395460	12/2019	Haratipour et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0082928	12/2020	Chen et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0202510	12/2020	Thareja et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0202511	12/2020	Yeong et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0202689	12/2020	Thareja et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0233920	12/2020	Sukekawa	N/A	N/A
2021/0272896	12/2020	Lin et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0343731	12/2020	Chen et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0398991	12/2020	Manfrini et al.	N/A	N/A
2021/0398992	12/2020	Wu et al.	N/A	N/A
2022/0199634	12/2021	Calderoni et al.	N/A	N/A
2022/0285376	12/2021	Chen et al.	N/A	N/A
2022/0344338	12/2021	Yang et al.	N/A	N/A
2022/0376075	12/2021	Manfrini et al.	N/A	N/A
2022/0399352	12/2021	Leng	N/A	N/A
2023/0187476	12/2022	Sato et al.	N/A	N/A
2023/0189532	12/2022	Müller	N/A	N/A

FOREIGN PATENT DOCUMENTS

Patent No.	Application Date	Country	CPC
102015015854	12/2016	DE	N/A
2006352005	12/2005	JP	N/A
4428500	12/2009	JP	N/A
100481867	12/2004	KR	N/A
100601953	12/2005	KR	N/A
100791074	12/2007	KR	N/A
100901950	12/2008	KR	N/A
2004076166	12/2003	WO	N/A

OTHER PUBLICATIONS

Coll et al., “Nanocrystalline Ferroelectric BiFeO₃ Thin Films by Low-Temperature Atomic Layer Deposition,” *Chem. Mater.* 2015, 27, 18, 6322-6328 Publication Date: Aug. 20, 2015.
<https://doi.org/10.1021/acs.chemmater.5b02093>. cited by applicant

Chowdhury et al., “Alumina as a Hydrogen Barrier Layer for FeRAM Devices,” 2007 Non-Volatile Memory Technology Symposium, 2007, pp. 49-52, doi: 10.1109/NVMT.2007.4389944. cited by applicant

Desu et al., “Reactive ion etching of ferroelectric SrBi₂TaxNb_{2-x}O₉ thin films,” *Appl. Phys. Lett.* 68, 566 (1996); <https://doi.org/10.1063/1.116402>. (3 pages). cited by applicant

Lee et al., “Plasma-Assisted Dry Etching of Ferroelectric Capacitor Modules and Application to a 32M Ferroelectric Random Access Memory Devices with Submicron Feature Size,” *Japanese Journal of Applied Physics*, vol. 41, No. 11S, 2002. pp. 6749-6753. (5 pages). cited by applicant

Mauersberger et al., “Single-Step Reactive Ion Etching Process for Device integration of Hafnium-Zirconium-Oxide (HZO)/Titanium Nitride (TiN) Stacks.” 2021 *Semicond. Sci. Technol.* 36 095025, <https://doi.org/10.1088/1361-6641/ac1827> (7 pages). cited by applicant

News Release Jun. 22, 2021, “Perovskite memory devices with ultra-fast switching speed,” Pohang University of Science & Technology (Postech), Downloaded on Oct. 19, 2021 from <https://www.eurekalert.org/news-releases/603724>. (2 pages). cited by applicant

Schneider et al., “Dry-etching of barium-strontium-titanate thin films,” *Proceedings of the 11th IEEE International Symposium on Applications of Ferroelectrics* (Cat. No. 98CH36245) (pp. 51-54). IEEE. Aug. 1998. DOI: 10.1109/ISAF.1998.786634. (4 pages). cited by applicant

Shi et al., “Reactive ion etching of sol-gel-derived BST thin film,” *Ceramics International* vol. 30, Iss. 7, 2004, pp. 1513-1516. (4 pages). cited by applicant

Ueda et al., “Plasma etching of PZT capacitor using ISM plasma source for ferroelectric memory application,” *Integrated Ferroelectrics*, 39:1-4, 23-30, DOI: 10.1080/10584580108011924. (8 pages). cited by applicant

Walters, “Scaling and Design of Thin Film Ferroelectric Hafnium Oxide for Memory and Logic Devices,” Dissertation for PhD Philosophy, University of Florida, 2020 (170 pages). cited by applicant

Wang et al., “Ferroelectric Devices and Circuits for Neuro-Inspired Computing,” *MRS Communications* (2020), 10, 538-548, doi: 10.1557/mrc.2020.71, (11 pages). cited by applicant

Yeh et al., “Fabrication and Investigation of Three-Dimensional Ferroelectric Capacitors for the Application of FeRAM,” *AIP Advances*, 6 035128(2016); doi: 10.1063/1.4945405. 13 pages. cited by applicant

Yu et al., “Atomic layer deposited ultrathin metal nitride barrier layers for ruthenium interconnect applications” *Journal of Vacuum Science & Technology A* 35, 03E109 (2017); <https://doi.org/10.1116/1.4979709>. cited by applicant

Final Office Action notified Jul. 19, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/478,849. cited by applicant

Final Office Action notified Sep. 14, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/465,792. cited by applicant

First Office Action mailed Nov. 3, 2023 for TW Patent Application No. 111132919 Office Action recalled for typographical errors. cited by applicant

First Office Action mailed Nov. 14, 2023 for TW Patent Application No. 111132919 Office Action issued on Nov. 3, 2023 recalled for typographical errors. cited by applicant

Non-Final Office Action notified Apr. 25, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/478,850. cited by applicant

Non-Final Office Action notified Aug. 3, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/552,293. cited by applicant

Non-Final Office Action notified Aug. 3, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/552,345. cited by applicant

Non-Final Office Action notified Aug. 15, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/552,269. cited by applicant

Non-Final Office Action notified Dec. 21, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/465,792. cited by applicant

Non-Final Office Action notified Jan. 18, 2024 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/502,942. cited by applicant

Non-Final Office Action notified Jan. 19, 2024 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/503,009. cited by applicant

Non-Final Office Action notified Jul. 20, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/550,899. cited by applicant
Non-Final Office Action notified Jul. 20, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/552,266. cited by applicant
Non-Final Office Action notified Jul. 20, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/552,330. cited by applicant
Non-Final Office Action notified Mar. 15, 2024 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/485,161. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Apr. 3, 2024 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/465,792. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Aug. 7, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/553,486. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Aug. 7, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/553,496. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Aug. 10, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/553,475. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Aug. 11, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/478,849. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Dec. 7, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/552,330. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Dec. 13, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/552,321. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Dec. 28, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/552,269. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Dec. 28, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/552,293. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Feb. 16, 2024 for Taiwan Patent Application No. 111132919. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Jan. 18, 2024 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/552,323. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Jan. 24, 2024 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/552,345. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Jul. 3, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/550,904. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Jul. 17, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/553,480. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Jul. 19, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/553,508. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Jul. 20, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/553,469. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Jul. 24, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/553,472. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Jul. 26, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/553,511. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Jun. 15, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/396,609. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Nov. 13, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/465,796. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Nov. 22, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/550,899. cited by applicant
Notice of Allowance notified Nov. 29, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/552,266. cited by applicant
Office Action—Written Primary Examination Decision—notified Jan. 10, 2024 for Taiwan Patent Application No. 111132920. cited by applicant
Office Action notified May 16, 2023 for Taiwan Patent Application No. 111132920. cited by applicant
Restriction Requirement notified Apr. 26, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/550,899. cited by applicant
Restriction Requirement notified Apr. 26, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/552,266. cited by applicant
Restriction Requirement notified Apr. 26, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/552,321. cited by applicant
Restriction Requirement notified Jul. 13, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/552,269. cited by applicant
Restriction Requirement notified May 1, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/552,330. cited by applicant
Restriction Requirement notified May 1, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/552,345. cited by applicant
Restriction Requirement notified Sep. 14, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/465,796. cited by applicant
Final Office Action notified Apr. 6, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/396,609. cited by applicant
Non-Final Office Action notified Dec. 8, 2022 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/396,609. cited by applicant
Non-Final Office Action notified Mar. 31, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/465,792. cited by applicant
Non-Final Office Action notified Mar. 31, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/478,849. cited by applicant
Restriction Requirement notified Aug. 22, 2022 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/396,609. cited by applicant
Restriction Requirement notified Dec. 30, 2022 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/465,92. cited by applicant
Restriction Requirement notified Jan. 11, 2023 for U.S. Appl. No. 17/478,849. cited by applicant

Primary Examiner: Green; Yara B

Assistant Examiner: Roland; Christopher M

Background/Summary

CLAIM FOR PRIORITY (1) This Application is a Continuation of, and claims the benefit of priority to, U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/465,792, filed Sep. 2, 2021, and titled “Pocket Integration Process for Embedded Memory,” which is incorporated by reference in its entirety for all purposes.

BACKGROUND

(1) Integration of ferroelectric random-access memory (FeRAM) devices on a same plane as interconnects of logic devices can be challenging. FeRAM devices include materials that have a variety of thicknesses and be difficult to etch. Targeting a device thickness in a memory region with a height constraint of interconnects in an adjacent logic region is challenging. As such alternate methods to pattern and form devices that include ferroelectric materials are essential to realize a high-density array.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) The material described herein is illustrated by way of example and not by way of limitation in the accompanying figures. For simplicity and clarity of illustration, elements illustrated in the figures are not necessarily drawn to scale. For example, the dimensions of some elements may be exaggerated relative to other elements for clarity. Also, various physical features may be represented in their simplified “ideal” forms and geometries for clarity of discussion, but it is nevertheless to be understood that practical implementations may only approximate the illustrated ideals. For example, smooth surfaces and square intersections may be drawn in disregard of finite roughness, corner-rounding, and imperfect angular intersections characteristic of structures formed by nanofabrication techniques. Further, where considered appropriate, reference labels have been repeated among the figures to indicate corresponding or analogous elements.
- (2) FIG. 1A is a cross-sectional illustration of a plurality of ferroelectric memory devices in a memory region adjacent to interconnect structures in a logic region, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (3) FIG. 1B is a cross-sectional illustration of a ferroelectric memory device above a transition electrode, where a lateral thickness of the transition electrode is equal to a lateral thickness of the ferroelectric memory device and two times a thickness of a spacer adjacent to the transition electrode, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (4) FIG. 1C is a cross-sectional illustration of layers within a ferroelectric memory device including a hardmask, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (5) FIG. 1D is a cross-sectional illustration of a ferroelectric memory device that includes a conductive hardmask, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (6) FIG. 1E is a cross-sectional illustration of a ferroelectric memory device that includes a dielectric hardmask, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (7) FIG. 1F is a cross-sectional illustration of a ferroelectric memory device on a conductive interconnect, where the conductive interconnect has a greater lateral thickness than a lateral thickness of the ferroelectric memory device, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.
- (8) FIG. 1G is a cross-sectional illustration of a ferroelectric memory device that includes a hard

mask including a dielectric material, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(9) FIG. 1H is a cross-sectional illustration of a ferroelectric memory device that includes a dual hard mask that includes a layer of dielectric material on a layer of conductive material.

(10) FIG. 1I is an isometric illustration of a plurality of ferroelectric memory devices in a memory region where a top electrode of individual ones of the plurality of ferroelectric memory devices are coupled to a common planar electrode, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(11) FIG. 1J is an isometric illustration of a plurality of ferroelectric memory devices in a memory region adjacent to interconnect structures in a logic region, where conductive interconnects in the memory region are trenches that couple more than one ferroelectric memory device, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(12) FIG. 2A is an isometric illustration of a plurality of ferroelectric memory devices in a memory region, where conductive interconnects in the memory region are trenches that couple more than one ferroelectric memory device, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(13) FIG. 2B is an isometric illustration of a plurality of ferroelectric memory devices in a memory region, where conductive interconnects in the memory region are trenches that couple more than one ferroelectric memory device, and where an encapsulation layer extends continuously between a pair of ferroelectric memory devices and over a respective trench connecting the pair of ferroelectric memory devices, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(14) FIG. 3 is an isometric illustration of a plurality of ferroelectric memory devices in a memory region, where conductive interconnects in the memory region are trenches that couple more than one ferroelectric memory device, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(15) FIG. 4 is an isometric illustration of a plurality of ferroelectric memory devices in a memory region, where conductive interconnects in the memory region are trenches that couple more than one ferroelectric memory device, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(16) FIG. 5 is a flow diagram of a method to fabricate a ferroelectric memory device adjacent to interconnects in a logic region, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure.

(17) FIG. 6A is a cross-sectional illustration of a plurality of conductive interconnects formed within a first dielectric in a memory region and in a logic region above a substrate and following the formation of an etch stop layer on the conductive interconnects.

(18) FIG. 6B is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. 6A following the process to etch a portion of an etch stop layer **126** from a memory region.

(19) FIG. 6C is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. 6B following the process to deposit an electrode material on the conductive interconnects in the memory region, on a first dielectric and on the etch stop layer and following the formation of a material layer stack to form ferroelectric memory devices.

(20) FIG. 6D is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. 6C following the process to form ferroelectric memory devices.

(21) FIG. 6E is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. 6D following the process to deposit an encapsulation layer on the ferroelectric memory devices and on the electrode material.

(22) FIG. 6F is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. 6E following the process to form a block mask on the encapsulation layer to isolate each ferroelectric memory device.

(23) FIG. 7A is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. 6F following the process to etch the encapsulation layer.

(24) FIG. 7B is a plan-view illustration of the structure in FIG. 7A, in an embodiment where conductive interconnects are discrete islands, and the block mask forms a substantially circular encapsulation layer around a sidewall of each ferroelectric memory device.

(25) FIG. 7C is a plan-view illustration of the structure in FIG. 7A, in an embodiment where the conductive interconnects are trenches and the mask forms an encapsulation layer around sidewall of each ferroelectric memory device.

- (26) FIG. 7D is a plan-view illustration of the structure in FIG. 7A, in an embodiment where the conductive interconnects are trenches and the mask forms an encapsulation layer around sidewall of each ferroelectric memory device.
- (27) FIG. 8A is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. 7A following the process to form openings in a second dielectric formed above the ferroelectric memory devices.
- (28) FIG. 8B is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. 8A following the process to remove the mask and deposit a conductive material to form via electrodes.
- (29) FIG. 8C is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. 8B following the process to form a mask on the second dielectric, and on the via electrodes.
- (30) FIG. 8D is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. 8C following the process to etch the second dielectric to form hanging trenches in the logic region **101B**.
- (31) FIG. 8E is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. 8D following the process to etch the second dielectric to form a via within in the hanging trench in the logic region.
- (32) FIG. 8F is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. 8E following the process to remove the mask and deposit a conductive material into the openings to form via and metal lines.
- (33) FIG. 9A is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. 6F, following a process to etch the encapsulation layer to remove or reduce a thickness of a residue portion.
- (34) FIG. 9B is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. 9A following a process to etch and remove the electrode material to form ferroelectric memory devices.
- (35) FIG. 10 illustrates a computing architecture with a coherent cache or memory-side buffer chiplet that includes a memory controller, wherein the coherent cache or memory-side buffer chiplet is coupled to an accelerator, a processor, and a memory, in accordance with at least one embodiment.
- (36) FIG. 11 illustrates an architecture of the coherent cache or memory-side buffer chiplet with multiple controllers and multiple cache banks, in accordance with at least one embodiment.
- (37) FIG. 12 illustrates an apparatus comprising memory and corresponding logic, wherein the memory comprises ferroelectric (FE) memory bit-cells, in accordance with at least one embodiment.
- (38) FIG. 13 illustrates a high-level architecture of an artificial intelligence (AI) machine comprising a compute die positioned on top of a memory die, in accordance with at least one embodiment.
- (39) FIG. 14 illustrates a 3-input majority gate using non-linear input capacitors, in accordance with at least one embodiment.
- (40) FIG. 15 illustrates a complex logic gate implemented using a 5-input majority gate, in accordance with at least one embodiment.
- (41) FIG. 16A illustrates the structure of FIG. 8E following the process to form openings in a second dielectric formed above the ferroelectric memory devices and form trench openings in the logic region, in accordance with at least one embodiment.
- (42) FIG. 16B illustrates the structure of FIG. 16A following the process to form a mask on the second dielectric in the openings in the memory region, in the trench openings, where the mask forms a via opening in one of the trench openings.
- (43) FIG. 16C illustrates the structure of FIG. 16B following the process to remove the mask and expose a ferroelectric memory device in each opening in the memory region, and remove the mask in the logic region.
- (44) FIG. 16D illustrates the structure of FIG. 16C following the process to form via electrodes in the openings in the memory region.

DETAILED DESCRIPTION

(45) Pocket integration process for embedded memory is described. While various embodiments are described with reference to FeRAM, capacitive structures formed herein can be used for any application where a capacitor is desired. For example, the capacitive structure can be used for

fabricating ferroelectric based or paraelectric based majority gate, minority gate, and/or threshold gate. In the following description, numerous specific details are set forth, such as structural schemes and detailed fabrication methods to provide a thorough understanding of embodiments of the present disclosure. It will be apparent to one skilled in the art that embodiments of the present disclosure may be practiced without these specific details. In other instances, well-known features, such as process equipment and device operations, are described in lesser detail to not unnecessarily obscure embodiments of the present disclosure. Furthermore, it is to be understood that the various embodiments shown in the Figures are illustrative representations and are not necessarily drawn to scale.

(46) In some instances, in the following description, well-known methods and devices are shown in block diagram form, rather than in detail, to avoid obscuring the present disclosure. Reference throughout this specification to “an embodiment” or “one embodiment” means that a particular feature, structure, function, or characteristic described in connection with the embodiment, is included in at least one embodiment of the disclosure. The appearances of the phrase “in an embodiment” or “in one embodiment” in various places throughout this specification are not necessarily referring to the same embodiment of the disclosure. Furthermore, the particular features, structures, functions, or characteristics may be combined in any suitable manner in one or more embodiments. For example, a first embodiment may be combined with a second embodiment, anywhere the particular features, structures, functions, or characteristics associated with the two embodiments are not mutually exclusive.

(47) As used in the description and the appended claims, the singular forms “a”, “an” and “the” are intended to include the plural forms as well, unless the context clearly indicates otherwise. It will also be understood that the term “and/or” as used herein refers to and encompasses any and all possible combinations of one or more of the associated listed items.

(48) The terms “coupled” and “connected,” along with their derivatives, may be used herein to describe functional or structural relationships between components. It should be understood that these terms are not intended as synonyms for each other. Rather, in particular embodiments, “connected” may be used to indicate that two or more elements are in direct physical, optical, or electrical contact with each other. “Coupled” may be used to indicate that two or more elements are in either direct or indirect (with other intervening elements between them) physical, electrical or in magnetic contact with each other, and/or that the two or more elements co-operate or interact with each other (e.g., as in a cause an effect relationship).

(49) The terms “over,” “under,” “between,” and “on” as used herein refer to a relative position of one component or material with respect to other components or materials where such physical relationships are noteworthy. For example, in the context of materials, one material or material disposed over or under another may be directly in contact or may have one or more intervening materials. Moreover, one material disposed between two materials may be directly in contact with the two layers or may have one or more intervening layers. In contrast, a first material “on” a second material is in direct contact with that second material/material. Similar distinctions are to be made in the context of component assemblies. As used throughout this description, and in the claims, a list of items joined by the term “at least one of” or “one or more of” can mean any combination of the listed terms.

(50) The term “adjacent” here generally refers to a position of a thing being next to (e.g., immediately next to or close to with one or more things between them) or adjoining another thing (e.g., abutting it).

(51) The term “signal” may refer to at least one current signal, voltage signal, magnetic signal, or data/clock signal. The meaning of “a,” “an,” and “the” include plural references. The meaning of “in” includes “in” and “on.”

(52) The term “device” may generally refer to an apparatus according to the context of the usage of that term. For example, a device may refer to a stack of layers or structures, a structure or layer, a

connection of various structures having active and/or passive elements, etc. Generally, a device is a three-dimensional structure with a plane along the x-y direction and a height along the z direction of an x-y-z Cartesian coordinate system. The plane of the device may also be the plane of an apparatus which comprises the device.

(53) As used throughout this description, and in the claims, a list of items joined by the term “at least one of” or “one or more of” can mean any combination of the listed terms.

(54) Unless otherwise specified in the explicit context of their use, the terms “substantially equal,” “about equal,” and “approximately equal” mean that there is no more than incidental variation between two things so described. In the art, such variation is typically no more than $\pm 10\%$ of a predetermined target value.

(55) The terms “left,” “right,” “front,” “back,” “top,” “bottom,” “over,” “under,” and the like in the description and in the claims, if any, are used for descriptive purposes and not necessarily for describing permanent relative positions. For example, the terms “over,” “under,” “front side,” “back side,” “top,” “bottom,” “over,” “under,” and “on” as used herein refer to a relative position of one component, structure, or material with respect to other referenced components, structures or materials within a device, where such physical relationships are noteworthy. These terms are employed herein for descriptive purposes only and predominantly within the context of a device z-axis and therefore may be relative to an orientation of a device. Hence, a first material “over” a second material in the context of a figure provided herein may also be “under” the second material if the device is oriented upside-down relative to the context of the figure provided. In the context of materials, one material disposed over or under another may be directly in contact or may have one or more intervening materials. Moreover, one material disposed between two materials may be directly in contact with the two layers or may have one or more intervening layers. In contrast, a first material “on” a second material is in direct contact with that second material. Similar distinctions are to be made in the context of component assemblies.

(56) The term “between” may be employed in the context of the z-axis, x-axis or y-axis of a device. A material that is between two other materials may be in contact with one or both of those materials, or it may be separated from both of the other two materials by one or more intervening materials. A material “between” two other materials may therefore be in contact with either of the other two materials, or it may be coupled to the other two materials through an intervening material. A device that is between two other devices may be directly connected to one or both of those devices, or it may be separated from both of the other two devices by one or more intervening devices.

(57) Perovskite FeRAM devices are advantageous for high density memory applications owing to their low power consumption and high on/off ratio. Perovskite FeRAM devices are also desirable over other forms of memory such as magnetic tunnel junction-based devices due to the relatively low number of layers implemented for device functionality. A typical FeRAM may be fully operational with three layers, where a ferroelectric dielectric is contained between two electrode layers. The electrode layers may also include perovskite materials to enable lattice matching and reduction in electrical resistance. Introduction of lead-free perovskite materials offer additional environmental benefits without sacrificing device performance.

(58) Ferroelectric capacitors may be integrated with transistors to form FeRAM devices. FeRAM devices may be directly adjacent to logic regions to enable system functionality. In particular, the ferroelectric capacitor may be formed on a level that is directly adjacent to routing interconnects of a logic region. The height of the level may be influenced by a total combined thickness of the vias and metal lines in the routing interconnects of the logic region. However, ferroelectric capacitors can span a total thickness that depends on thicknesses of individual layers in the memory devices, where the thickness can be equal to a thickness of one or more levels of the routing interconnects.

(59) For manufacturability, a ferroelectric capacitor in a plurality of ferroelectric capacitors may be generally formed directly on a respective transition electrode. The transition electrode may be

directly between the ferroelectric capacitor and a respective conductive interconnect that is coupled with a respective transistor on a lower level. A transition electrode is generally implemented because the conductive interconnect is fashioned from a material such as copper. The transition electrode can act as diffusion barrier, where the transition electrode can have a surface area that is greater than a surface area of the conductive interconnect to prevent copper from being exposed during formation of the ferroelectric capacitor.

(60) However, a transition electrode may add to a total thickness of the ferroelectric capacitor. An increase in thickness can require additional levels of routing interconnects in the logic region. Additional layers can be detrimental in terms of cost as well as for electrical resistance. For example, in some cases, an increase in thickness of the ferroelectric capacitor is incrementally small, that more than a level of routing interconnects in the logic region may be required. In some such examples, a thickness of a via electrode coupled above the ferroelectric capacitor may need to be unnecessarily taller to span a total thickness of the more than a level of routing interconnects in the logic region. Increasing thickness of the via electrode can increase electrical line resistance in the ferroelectric capacitor.

(61) However, to reduce a total height of the ferroelectric capacitor, the transition electrode may be removed. However, the relative area of a lowermost layer of the ferroelectric capacitor may be tuned relative to an area of a top surface of the conductive interconnect, depending on a material of the conductive interconnect. In examples where the conductive interconnect may include copper it is highly desirable that the ferroelectric capacitor have an area footprint where a perimeter of the area footprint overlaps a perimeter of the conductive interconnect. An overlap can prevent copper from being exposed while a patterning process is carried out to form the ferroelectric capacitor. In other examples, when the conductive interconnect includes a material other than copper the area footprint of the ferroelectric capacitor may be less than, equal to or greater than the area footprint of the conductive interconnect.

(62) While the transition electrode may be removed in the memory region, in at least one embodiment, an insulator layer is implemented to facilitate formation of the transition electrode may remain in the logic region. The insulator layer may be in direct contact with the conductive interconnect in the logic region. The insulator layer may be advantageously implemented in the logic region to enable targeting of a known thickness of a dielectric material for patterning a via between a respective conductive interconnect and a metal line in the logic region.

(63) The inventors have devised a method that provides for ferroelectric capacitors to be on the conductive interconnect in the memory region and an insulator layer to be exclusively in the logic region. The method further facilitates formation of a ferroelectric capacitor having a thickness that can be tuned to a desired thickness that is substantially within a level of the routing interconnect in the logic region. Additionally, the method permits implementation of an insulator layer with a substantially fixed thickness in the logic region. The method utilizes a multistep subtractive patterning process where a first operation forms a ferroelectric capacitor device, and a second operation forms the routing interconnect in the logic region. In an exemplary embodiment, the second process also includes patterning an encapsulation around the device.

(64) To enable high density FeRAM devices the inventors have resorted to non-lead-based perovskite materials owing its environmental friendliness for mass production. A stack for ferroelectric capacitors can include one or more hardmask materials. The hardmask material can include dielectric materials, metallic materials or a combination thereof. Implementation of an etch with high selectivity (such as a reactive ion etching, or plasma etch process) between the hardmask and device layers can advantageously enable a total stack thickness that is less than a total thickness of layers within an adjacent conductive interconnect level.

(65) In at least one embodiment, the conductive interconnects that are coupled with a respective ferroelectric capacitor are discrete island structures. In other embodiments, the conductive interconnect may be a continuous trench line, where a plurality of capacitors may be coupled with

the trench line. In some such embodiments, the encapsulation layer may be continuous between a respective ferroelectric capacitor and extend along a length of the trench line. In further embodiments, the conductive interconnects are discrete, but a top electrode of individual ferroelectric capacitors are coupled together by a conductive plate. The conductive plate may be within the same level as the level of the routing interconnects.

(66) FIG. 1A is a cross-sectional illustration of a device structure **100**, including a region **101A**, adjacent to a region **101B**. The region **101A** and **101B** may be for example a memory region and a logic region, respectively or vice versa. In at least one embodiment, region **101A** is a memory region and region **101B** is a logic region. The memory region **101A** includes a plurality of conductive interconnects, such as conductive interconnect **102** within level **104**. The device structure **100** further includes a second level **106** above level **104**. Second level **106** may include memory devices. In at least one embodiment, second level **106** includes a plurality of ferroelectric memory devices, such as ferroelectric memory device **108** above a respective conductive interconnect **102**. To protect layers within the ferroelectric memory device **108** from degradation during a fabrication process, an encapsulation layer **114** is adjacent to sidewalls and on top surfaces of ferroelectric memory device **108**. In at least one embodiment, encapsulation layer **114** is on sidewalls **108A** and on uppermost surface **108B** of ferroelectric memory device **108**.

(67) The ferroelectric memory device **108** may be wider than or narrower than the conductive interconnect **102**, depending on the material of the conductive interconnect **102**. In at least one embodiment, ferroelectric memory device **108** is wider conductive interconnect **102** and can include a material such as copper or cobalt. The encapsulation layer **114** has a thickness, TEC, as measured from sidewall **108A**. In at least one embodiment, the encapsulation layer **114** also extends laterally on an uppermost surface **136A** of a dielectric **136**, beyond the thickness, TEC. Lateral extensions **114B** may have a length, LEX, as measured laterally from an outermost sidewall **114A** of the encapsulation layer **114**. The encapsulation layer **114** can laterally extend on a portion of an uppermost surface **136A** of the dielectric **136** by a distance that is at least 25% of the thickness, TEC, of the encapsulation layer **114**. LEX may be between 2 nm and 10 nm. Lateral extensions **114B** of the encapsulation layer **114** may not be symmetrical about the ferroelectric memory device **108**.

(68) In at least one embodiment, the encapsulation layer **114** has a thickness that is sufficiently large that the encapsulation layer **114** does not extend laterally beyond thickness, TEC as illustrated in FIG. 1B. In at least one embodiment, TEC can also vary as a function of height or vertical thickness, T.sub.MD of ferroelectric memory device **108**. TEC may increase or decrease with T.sub.MD.

(69) In at least one embodiment, the encapsulation layer **114** illustrated in FIG. 1B can further extend below an uppermost surface **136A** of dielectric **136** or a lower most surface **108D** of ferroelectric memory device **108** as shown in FIG. 1C. In some such embodiments, the dielectric **136** has an uppermost surface **136A** and a lower surface **136B** below uppermost surface **136A**. In at least one embodiment, lower surface **136B** is substantially planar. Lower surface **136B** may be sloped. As shown, when the dielectric includes a recessed lower surface **136B**, the encapsulation layer **114** can further extend on lower surface **136B** as well as on a sidewall portion **136C**. Sidewall portion **136C** can be substantially aligned with sidewall **108A**.

(70) In other embodiments, the encapsulation layer **114** can also laterally extend onto lower surface **136B** as shown in FIG. 1D. In embodiments, the dielectric **136** has one or more properties of dielectric **136**, and encapsulation layer **114** has one or more properties of encapsulation layer **114** depicted in FIG. 1C. As shown in FIG. 1D, lateral extensions of encapsulation layer **114** can be on a lower surface **136B**. In other embodiments, the encapsulation layer **114** follows a surface topography of lower surface **136B** of dielectric **136**. The different surface topographies discussed above are a consequence of processing sequence utilized to fabricate ferroelectric memory device **108**.

(71) Referring again to FIG. 1A, second level **106** also includes a via electrode **116** coupled with a respective ferroelectric memory device **108**. As shown, ferroelectric memory device **108** has a vertical thickness $T_{\text{sub.MD}}$, and via electrode **116** has a vertical thickness, $T_{\text{sub.VE}}$. Second level **106** has a vertical thickness, $T_{\text{sub.106}}$ that is substantially equal to a combined sum of $T_{\text{sub.MD}}$, and $T_{\text{sub.VE}}$. Individual thicknesses $T_{\text{sub.MD}}$, and $T_{\text{sub.VE}}$ may be co-dependently chosen to optimize the ferroelectric memory device **108**. For example, a thicker $T_{\text{sub.MD}}$, corresponds to a thinner $T_{\text{sub.VE}}$ and vice versa.

(72) In at least one embodiment, the logic region **101B** includes an interconnect structure **117** spanning level **104** and second level **106**. The interconnect structure **117** includes one or more conductive interconnects in level **104** and one or more vias and metal lines coupled with conductive interconnect **118** in second level **106**. In at least one embodiment, interconnect structure **117** includes a conductive interconnect **118** in level **104** and a plurality of metal lines **120** and **122**, where metal line **122** is coupled with conductive interconnect **118** through a via **124**. Metal line **122** may be coupled with a conductive interconnect through a via on a different plane, behind the plane of the illustration.

(73) The via **124** has a vertical thickness, $T_{\text{sub.V}}$, as measured from a lower most point of level **104** or from uppermost surface **118A** of conductive interconnect **118**, and metal line **122** has a vertical thickness, $T_{\text{sub.M}}$. $T_{\text{sub.106}}$ is also substantially equal to a combined sum of $T_{\text{sub.M}}$, and $T_{\text{sub.V}}$. In exemplary embodiments, a combined sum of $T_{\text{sub.M}}$ and $T_{\text{sub.V}}$ is equal to a combined sum of individual thicknesses $T_{\text{sub.MD}}$, and $T_{\text{sub.VE}}$. In general, $T_{\text{sub.M}}$ and $T_{\text{sub.VE}}$ need not be equal. $T_{\text{sub.M}}$ can be greater than $T_{\text{sub.VE}}$ or vice versa. In at least one embodiment, when $T_{\text{sub.MD}}$ is less than $T_{\text{sub.V}}$, $T_{\text{sub.VE}}$ is greater than $T_{\text{sub.M}}$. In at least one embodiment, $T_{\text{sub.VE}}$ can be as much as 4 times greater than $T_{\text{sub.M}}$, when $T_{\text{sub.MD}}$ is less than 20 nm. In some such embodiments, $T_{\text{sub.M}}$ can be between 20 nm and 50 nm.

(74) In other embodiments, when $T_{\text{sub.MD}}$ is greater than $T_{\text{sub.V}}$, $T_{\text{sub.VE}}$ is between 5% to 20% of $T_{\text{sub.M}}$. For example, $T_{\text{sub.MD}}$ can be as much as 100 nm. In other embodiments, $T_{\text{sub.M}}$ can be between 20 nm and 200 nm.

(75) The logic region **101B** also includes an etch stop layer **126** between the conductive interconnect **118** and metal line **122**. In at least one embodiment, etch stop layer **126** spans the logic region **101B**, and is directly on a portion of conductive interconnect **118**. Via **124** is coupled with conductive interconnect **118** through etch stop layer **126**. The etch stop layer **126** has a thickness, TL . TL may be chosen based on a desired profile and thickness of via **124** as will be discussed below. The etch stop layer **126** includes a material that is different from a material of the encapsulation layer **114**.

(76) In at least one embodiment, a portion **108C** (herein stack portion **108C**), which includes one or more layers of ferroelectric memory device **108** is on dielectric **136**, adjacent to the etch stop layer **126** as shown. Stack portion **108C** may extend to various heights along sidewall **126A**. The stack portion **108C** may be an artifact of a processing methodology utilized to fabricate device structure **100**. Other embodiments of device structure **100** may not include stack portion **108C**.

(77) In at least one embodiment, each ferroelectric memory device **108** within device structure **100** are substantially identical. While two ferroelectric memory device **108** are illustrated, an array can have more than 1000 substantially identical ferroelectric memory devices **108**. Adjacent ferroelectric memory devices **108** may be laterally separated from each other by a distance, $S_{\text{sub.M}}$. $S_{\text{sub.M}}$ may range between 20 nm and 50 nm. The separation, $S_{\text{sub.M}}$, is dependent on separation S_{ic} between adjacent conductive interconnects **102** as well as on lateral thicknesses, $W_{\text{sub.CI}}$ of the conductive interconnect **102**, as will be discussed further below.

(78) In embodiments, $S_{\text{sub.M}}$ may depend on a stack of layers within the ferroelectric memory device **108**. Depending on embodiments, the ferroelectric memory device **108** can have three or more layers. An embodiment of the ferroelectric memory device **108** including five layers is illustrated in FIG. 1E. As shown, ferroelectric memory device **108** includes a bottom electrode **128**,

a ferroelectric oxide layer **130** and a top electrode **132**. In at least one embodiment, ferroelectric memory device **108** also includes a diffusion barrier layer **135**. Diffusion barrier layer **135** may be implemented when the conductive interconnect **102** includes a material such as copper or cobalt. The diffusion barrier layer **135** may include a material such as but not limited to Al.sub.2O.sub.3, AlO.sub.x, HfO.sub.x, ZrO.sub.x, TaO.sub.x, TiO.sub.x, SiO.sub.x, SiN, SiCN, SiC, SiON, AlSiO.sub.x, HfSiO.sub.x, TaSiO.sub.x, TiON, TaON, AlN, ZrN, HfN, TiAlN, TiAlO, TiAl, W, Ru, Ir, Mo, Ta, Zr, Hf, Nb.

(79) In an embodiment, bottom electrode **128** and top electrode **132** include a conductive ferroelectric oxide. The conductive ferroelectric oxide includes one of a non-Pb perovskite metal oxides, such as but not limited to, La—Sr—CoO.sub.3, SrRuO.sub.3, La—Sr—MnO.sub.3, YBa.sub.2Cu.sub.3O.sub.7, BiSr.sub.2CaCu.sub.2O.sub.8, or LaNiO.sub.3.

(80) In an embodiment, the ferroelectric oxide layer **130** is a ferroelectric dielectric layer that includes non-Pb perovskite material in the form ABO.sub.3, where A and B are two cations of different sizes and O is oxygen. A is generally larger than B in size. In at least one embodiment, non-Pb perovskites can also be doped, e.g., by La or lanthanides. The non-Pb perovskite material can include one or more of La, Sr, Co, Cr, K, Nb, Na, Sr, Ru, Y, Fe, Ba, Hf, Zr, Cu, Ta, Bi, Ca, Ti, and Ni.

(81) In other embodiments, ferroelectric dielectric layer includes low voltage ferroelectric material between the top electrode **132** and bottom electrode **128**. These low voltage FE materials can be of the form AA'BB'O.sub.3, where A' is a dopant for atomic site A and can be an element from the lanthanides series, where B' is a dopant for atomic site B and can be an element from the transition metal elements such as Sc, Ti, V, Cr, Mn, Fe, Co, Ni, Cu, Zn. A' may have the same valency of site A, with a different ferroelectric polarizability. A voltage below X-Volts is sufficiently low to be characterized as low voltage.

(82) The ferroelectric memory device **108** may also include a hardmask **134** as shown. In at least one embodiment, the hardmask **134** may be a dielectric, where the dielectric includes a material such as silicon and one or more of nitrogen, oxygen, or carbon. In other embodiments, the hardmask includes a conductive material, for example, tantalum, titanium, ruthenium, or an alloy of nitrogen and one or more of tantalum, titanium, ruthenium. The combined thickness of the layers in the ferroelectric memory device **108** can range between 7 nm and 100 nm.

(83) In at least one embodiment, where ferroelectric memory device **108** includes a hardmask **134**, the material of hardmask **134** will determine whether via electrode **116** contacts hardmask **134** or extends through a portion of hardmask **134** and contacts top electrode **132**. As shown in FIG. 1F, where hardmask **134** includes a conductive material, via electrode **116** is in contact with uppermost hardmask surface **134A**. In other embodiments, where hardmask **134** includes a dielectric material, via electrode **116** extends through hardmask **134** and is in contact with uppermost surface **108B**, as shown in FIG. 1G.

(84) In a further embodiment, ferroelectric memory device **108** includes a dual hard mask where hardmask **134** is a dielectric and a hardmask **144** that includes a conductive material, as shown in FIG. 1H. A dual hardmask including hardmask **144** may be advantageous when the ferroelectric memory device **108** has a thickness T.sub.MD that is substantially less than T.sub.V (thickness of via **124**). For example, in at least one embodiment, T.sub.MD is between 10 nm and 30 nm and T.sub.V is as much as 100 nm, where the ratio is between 1:3 to 1:10. In some such embodiments, hardmask **144** compensates for shorter height of ferroelectric memory device **108**.

(85) Referring again to FIG. 1A, conductive interconnect **118** has one or more properties of conductive interconnect **102**. Conductive interconnects **102** and **118** include a material such as copper or tungsten. Conductive interconnects **102** and **118** have a thickness that spans a portion of dielectric **136** within level **104**. There may be other vias and interconnect routing connections within level **104** that are not shown in the Figure. In an embodiment, via electrode **116**, via **124**, metal lines **120** and **122**, include a same or substantially the same material. In at least one

embodiment, via electrode **116**, via **124**, metal lines **120** and **122**, include a same or substantially the same material as the material of the conductive interconnect **102**.

(86) In different embodiments, via electrode **116**, via **124**, conductive interconnects **102** and **118** can be discrete vias or continuous trenches.

(87) In accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure, FIG. **1I** is an isometric illustration of the device structure **100** in FIG. **1A**, where the conductive interconnect **102** are discrete islands. As shown, the memory region **101A** in device structure **100** further includes a plurality of memory devices such as ferroelectric memory device **140** (illustrated through a cut out in encapsulation layer **114**). The ferroelectric memory devices **140** are on a plane **141**, behind ferroelectric memory devices **108**. The ferroelectric memory devices **140** are substantially identical to and have all of the properties of the ferroelectric memory device **108**. In at least one embodiment, the respective ferroelectric memory device **108** or ferroelectric memory device **140** have a cylindrical shape. In at least one embodiment, each ferroelectric memory device **140** is coupled with a conductive interconnect **102** that is a discrete island. The ferroelectric memory devices **140** may be spaced apart from ferroelectric memory devices **108** by a distance, $S_{sub.M2}$. In at least one embodiment, a discrete via electrode **116** is coupled with a respective ferroelectric memory device **108** or ferroelectric memory device **140**.

(88) The ferroelectric memory device **108** can have a width, $W_{sub.MD}$, that is less or greater than a width, $W_{sub.CI}$, of the conductive interconnect **102**. In one embodiment, $W_{sub.CI}$ is less than $W_{sub.MD}$, when conductive interconnect includes, for example, copper. In another embodiment, $W_{sub.CI}$ is greater than $W_{sub.MD}$, (for example, conductive interconnect **102** in dashed lines in the figure) when conductive interconnect includes, for example, a conductive material other than copper.

(89) In at least one embodiment, the conductive interconnect **118** is a conductive interconnect **118** and extends along the y-direction. As shown, metal lines **120** and **122** also extend along the y-direction. In at least one embodiment, via **124** may be the only conductive via between metal line **122** and conductive interconnect **118**. In other embodiments, interconnect structure **117** can include a plurality of vias such as via **124** between metal line **122** and conductive interconnect **118** to prevent an increase in line resistance.

(90) In at least one embodiment, stack portion **108C** extends along the y-direction, parallel to the metal lines **120** and **122**.

(91) In at least one embodiment, the via electrode **116** coupled with each ferroelectric memory device **108** and **140** may be further coupled together by a common plate electrode **142**, such as is shown in the cross-sectional illustration of FIG. **1J**. The logic region **101B** is not illustrated for clarity. In one such embodiment, the plate electrode **142** may extend over and be coupled with a top of all memory devices such as ferroelectric memory devices **108** and **140**, through a respective via electrode **116**. In embodiments, the plate electrode **142** is within the second level **106**.

(92) In at least one embodiment, the conductive interconnect **102** includes a material other than copper, such as tungsten, ruthenium, titanium, tantalum, and/or nitrides of tungsten, ruthenium, titanium or tantalum. In some such embodiments, conductive interconnect **102** can be equal to or wider than the ferroelectric memory device **108**, as shown in FIG. **2A**. In one such embodiment, the conductive interconnect **102** continuously extends along a longitudinal direction, such as for example, from ferroelectric memory device **108** to ferroelectric memory device **140**, as shown. In at least one embodiment, the ferroelectric memory device **108** has a width, $W_{sub.MD}$, that is less than a width, $W_{sub.CI}$, of the conductive interconnect **102** along the length $L_{sub.CI}$.

(93) In at least one embodiment, where ferroelectric memory device **108** extends over a portion of, but not completely over conductive interconnect **102**, in one or both x and y directions, encapsulation layer **114** can also extend over conductive interconnect **102** along one or both directions as shown in FIG. **2A**. In at least one embodiment, encapsulation layer **114** is over and adjacent to each ferroelectric memory device **108** and **140**.

(94) In at least one embodiment, where conductive interconnect **102** extends along the y-direction but includes a material other than copper, the encapsulation layer **114** can also extend continuously along the y-direction as illustrated in FIG. 2B. The logic region **101B** is omitted for clarity. In some such embodiments, the ferroelectric memory device **108** can have a width, $W_{sub.MD}$, that is greater or less than a width, $W_{sub.CI}$, of the conductive interconnect **102**. In at least one embodiment, $W_{sub.MD}$ is greater than a width, $W_{sub.CI}$, of the conductive interconnect **102**.

(95) In further some such embodiments, encapsulation layer **114** has a lateral thickness $W_{sub.EC}$, that is at least equal to or greater than $W_{sub.CI}$, and a length, $L_{sub.EC}$, that extends along the y-direction. The encapsulation layer **114** can provide protection against oxidation of an uppermost surface of the conductive interconnect **102**.

(96) In at least one embodiment, the respective ferroelectric memory device **108** or ferroelectric memory device **140** have a cylindrical shape. In some such embodiments $W_{sub.MD}$, is a diameter the respective ferroelectric memory device **108** or ferroelectric memory device **140**.

(97) In other embodiments, the encapsulation layer **114** is continuous between adjacent ferroelectric memory devices **108**, between adjacent ferroelectric memory devices **140**, and between ferroelectric memory device **108** and **140**, as shown in FIG. 3. In some such embodiments, encapsulation layer **114** can also extend on etch stop layer **126**.

(98) FIG. 4 is an embodiment of the structure in FIG. 2A, where the encapsulation layer **114** has a lateral extension that extends beyond a thickness, $T_{sub.EC}$, of the encapsulation layer **114**, but the lateral thickness, or width, $W_{sub.EC}$, vary along the y-direction.

(99) FIG. 5 is a flow diagram to form a plurality of ferroelectric memory devices in a memory region and conductive interconnects in a logic region, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure. The method begins at operation **510**, with the formation of plurality of conductive interconnects in a dielectric. The method **500** continues at operation **520** with the deposition of an etch stop layer on the dielectric and on the plurality of conductive interconnects and removing the etch stop layer from a memory region but not from a logic region. The method continues at operation **530** with the deposition of a material layer stack to form memory devices on the electrode material. The method continues at operation **540** with the process to pattern the material layers stack for memory devices above each conductive interconnect in the memory region. The method continues at operation **550** with the deposition of an encapsulation layer on the memory devices. The method continues at operation **560** with the formation of a mask on the encapsulating layer and patterning the encapsulating layer and electrode material, where the mask is above each memory device. The method continues at operation **570** with a blanket deposition of a dielectric layer. The method continues at operation **580** with the formation of one or more openings in the dielectric layer and exposing one or more conductive interconnects in the logic region. The method concludes at operation **590** with the formation of one or more interconnect vias in the one or more openings and a metal line on a respective interconnect via.

(100) FIG. 6A is a cross-sectional illustration of a plurality of conductive interconnects **102** and **118** formed within a dielectric **136** above a substrate **600**. In at least one embodiment, conductive interconnects **102**, are formed in a memory region and conductive interconnect **118** is formed in a logic region. In exemplary embodiments, there may be one or more levels of transistors and interconnects between the conductive interconnects **102** and **118** and the substrate **600**. In high density memory applications, the number of conductive interconnects can range between 1K and 5K within a given array in the memory region **101A**. The conductive interconnects **102** and **118** have a lateral thickness, $W_{sub.CI}$, that may be determined by a minimum acceptable electrical resistance. In at least one embodiment, the conductive interconnects **102** are discrete structures that are substantially circular or elliptical in shape and conductive interconnect **118** is a trench line. The conductive interconnects **102** may have a maximum lateral thickness between 20 nm and 40 nm. For example, the conductive interconnects **102** may have a lateral thickness between 20 nm and 40 nm, along the x-direction, as shown. In other embodiments, each conductive interconnects **102** and

118 is a line that extends into the plane of the Figure. As shown conductive interconnects **102** and **118** have substantially the same lateral thickness to minimize variability in device performance. (101) In at least one embodiment, the conductive interconnects **102** and **118** are electrically and mechanically coupled with vias and/or lines such as via **601** and/or line **601** indicated in dashed boxes in the Figure. The via **601** and/or line **601** may include a same or substantially the same material as a material of the conductive interconnect **102**.

(102) In one or more embodiments, conductive interconnects **102** and **118** include copper. In at least one embodiment, conductive interconnects **102** and **118** include a liner layer and a fill metal on the liner layer. For example, the liner layer may include a material, such as but not limited to, ruthenium, cobalt or tantalum and the fill metal may include copper or tungsten. In an embodiment, each of the conductive interconnects **102** are separated by spacing Sic. Sic is substantially determined by a designed density of ferroelectric memory devices to be fabricated within a given area, as well as by underlying structures embedded within layers below the conductive interconnects **102**.

(103) In an embodiment, an etch stop layer **126** is deposited on the conductive interconnects **102** and **118** as well as on the dielectric **136**. The etch stop layer **126** is deposited to a thickness that is chosen to accommodate a height of a via to be formed, as well as to target an etch in the logic region **101B** in a downstream operation. In an embodiment, the etch stop layer **126** also serves as a diffusion barrier layer. A diffusion barrier layer is essential for preventing diffusion of copper from the conductive interconnect **118** to the ferroelectric memory devices to be formed. As such, the etch stop layer **126** includes material such as but not limited to silicon and one or more of nitrogen, oxygen, or carbon.

(104) FIG. **6B** is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. **6A** following the process to etch a portion of the etch stop layer **126** from a memory region. In an embodiment, a photoresist mask **602** is formed by a lithographic technique on the etch stop layer **126**. Exposed portions of the etch stop layer **126** may be etched by a plasma etch process through opening in the photoresist mask **602**. The etch process isolates the etch stop layer **126** to the logic region **101B** and exposes the dielectric **136** and conductive interconnects **102** in the memory region. The substrate **600** is not illustrated in FIGS. **6B-9B**, for clarity.

(105) FIG. **6C** is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. **6B** following the process of blanket deposition of a material layer stack **606** for the formation of a memory device on the conductive interconnects **102** and **118**, and on the dielectric **136** followed by deposition of a hardmask layer **608** on the material layer stack **606** and formation of a photoresist mask **609** on the hardmask layer **608**, in accordance with an embodiment of the present disclosure. In an exemplary embodiment, etch stop layer **126** and all layers of the material layer stack **606** are deposited in situ, e.g., without breaking vacuum. The material layer stack **606** may be deposited by an atomic layer deposition (ALD) process, a plasma enhanced chemical vapor deposition (PECVD), chemical vapor deposition (CVD) or a physical vapor deposition (PVD) process. In at least one embodiment, a conductive layer **606A** is blanket deposited on the electrode material **604**. In an exemplary embodiment, conductive layer **606A** includes a conductive ferroelectric oxide. The conductive ferroelectric oxide includes one of a non-Pb perovskite metal oxides, such as but not limited to, La—Sr—CoO_{sub.3}, SrRuO_{sub.3}, La—Sr—MnO_{sub.3}, YBa_{sub.2}Cu_{sub.3}O_{sub.7}, Bi₂Sr₂CaCu₂O_{sub.8}, or LaNiO_{sub.3}.

(106) The conductive layer **606A** is deposited to a thickness, $T_{sub.1}$, that is suitable for minimizing electrical resistance and flare in sidewalls during a patterning process to be utilized to fabricate ferroelectric memory devices. In at least one embodiment, the conductive layer **606A** has a thickness that is between 3 nm and 30 nm. A thickness of less than 30 nm is highly desirable to prevent significant tapering in sidewalls during the patterning process.

(107) The deposition process is continued by deposition of a ferroelectric dielectric layer **606B**. In an exemplary embodiment the ferroelectric dielectric layer **606B** is blanket deposited on the

conductive layer **606A**. The ferroelectric dielectric layer **606B** has a thickness, $T_{\text{sub.2}}$, that is between 1 nm and 30 nm. In at least one embodiment, ferroelectric dielectric layer **606B** includes non-Pb perovskite material in the form $\text{ABO}_{\text{sub.3}}$, where A and B are two cations of different sizes and O is oxygen. A is generally larger than B in size. In at least one embodiment, non-Pb perovskites can also be doped, e.g., by La or lanthanides. The non-Pb perovskite material can include one or more of La, Sr, Co, Cr, K, Nb, Na, Sr, Ru, Y, Fe, Ba, Hf, Zr, Cu, Ta, Bi, Ca, Ti and Ni.

(108) In other embodiments, ferroelectric dielectric layer **606B** includes low voltage ferroelectric material between the conductive oxide layers (**606A** and **606C**). Low voltage materials can be of the form $\text{AA}'\text{BB}'\text{O}_{\text{sub.3}}$, where A' is a dopant for atomic site A and can be an element from the lanthanides series and B' is a dopant for atomic site B and can be an element from the transition metal elements such as Sc, Ti, V, Cr, Mn, Fe, Co, Ni, Cu, Zn. A' may have the same valency of site A, with a different ferroelectric polarizability. A voltage below 3 Volts is sufficiently low to be characterized as low voltage.

(109) The deposition process is continued with a deposition of a conductive layer **606C** on the ferroelectric dielectric layer **606B**. In an exemplary embodiment, the conductive layer **606C** includes a material that is the same or substantially the same as the material of the conductive layer **606A**. When conductive layers **606A** and **606C** include the same material, the material layer stack is symmetric. In different embodiments, conductive layer **606C** can have a different thickness than the conductive layer **606A**. It is desirable for conductive layer **606C** to be as thin as possible to facilitate fabrication. In embodiments, conductive layer **606C** is deposited to a thickness, $T_{\text{sub.3}}$, between 3 nm and 30 nm.

(110) The deposition process concludes with the formation of a hardmask layer **608** on the conductive layer **606C**. In some embodiments, the hardmask layer **608** is blanket deposited by a PECVD, CVD or PVD process. In an embodiment, the hardmask layer **608** includes a material that has a favorable etch selectivity compared to the ferroelectric materials in the material layer stack **606**. In at least one embodiment, the hardmask layer **608** includes materials that can be patterned with high fidelity with respect to a masking layer formed on the hardmask layer **608**, for example $\text{SiO}_{\text{sub.2}}$, $\text{Si}_{\text{sub.3}}\text{N}_{\text{sub.4}}$, DLC (Diamond Like Carbon) or $\text{Al}_{\text{sub.2}}\text{O}_{\text{sub.3}}$. In at least one embodiment, the hardmask layer **608** may include a conductive material that is different from the conductive material of the ferroelectric material. In at least one embodiment, it is desirable to deposit hardmask layer **608** to a thickness, $T_{\text{sub.4}}$, that enables patterning of at least the conductive layer **606C**. In other embodiments, hardmask layer **608** may be deposited to a thickness, $T_{\text{sub.4}}$, that depends on a total thickness of material layer stack **606**. $T_{\text{sub.4}}$ may be at least 20 nm.

(111) In an embodiment, a photoresist mask **609** is formed on the hardmask layer **608** and is formed by a lithographic process. The photoresist mask **609** includes blocks **609A** and **609B**. Each block **609A-B** is a mask for patterning a discrete FeRAM device.

(112) FIG. **6D** is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. **6C** following the process to pattern hardmask layer and the layers in the material layer stack **606**. In an embodiment, the hardmask layer is etched by a plasma etch process to form hardmask **134**. The plasma etch process may include a discharge produced by a magnetic enhanced reactive ion etching mechanism, an electron cyclotron resonance discharge or an inductively coupled plasma discharge. The plasma parameters may be characterized by a range of plasma densities such as between $1\text{e}9$ - $1\text{e}12$ ions/ cm^3 , pressures in the range of 0.001 to 10 Torr, and electron temperatures in the range of 1-8 eV. It is highly desirable to pattern to form hardmask **134** to have substantially vertical side walls to prevent increase in the lateral thickness when patterning the remaining layers in the material layer stack **606**.

(113) In an exemplary embodiment, the hardmask **134** has a substantially vertical profile relative to an uppermost surface **136A**. In at least one embodiment, the photoresist mask **609** is removed after forming the hardmask **134**. The plasma etch process is continued to pattern conductive layer **606C**.

The hardmask **134** is utilized to pattern conductive layer **606C**. In an embodiment, a plasma etch process is utilized to etch the conductive layer **606C** to form a top electrode **132**. In at least one embodiment, the top electrode **132** has substantially vertical sidewalls **132A**. In other embodiments, the sidewalls **132A** are not vertical and have a slope that is different from 90° with respect to a normal to lowermost surface **132B**. In at least one embodiment, the hardmask **134** is removed during the plasma etch process as shown, when the hardmask **134** includes a dielectric material. The etch process is continued to etch ferroelectric dielectric layer **606B** to form etched ferroelectric oxide layer **130** (herein ferroelectric dielectric layer **130**). In other embodiments, the sidewalls **130A** of the ferroelectric dielectric layer **130** are sloped.

(114) The plasma etch process is continued to pattern and form a bottom electrode **128**. In an embodiment, the process utilized to etch conductive layer **606A** (FIG. 6C) to form bottom electrode **128** may be substantially the same as the etch process utilized to form top electrode **132**. In at least one embodiment, sidewalls **108A** of the ferroelectric memory device **108** are substantially vertical respect to a normal to uppermost surface **136A** or uppermost surface **108B**. In other embodiments, the sidewalls **108A** are not vertical and have a slope that is different from 90° with respect to a normal to uppermost surface **136A** or uppermost surface **108B**. The process of forming the top electrode **132**, ferroelectric dielectric layer **130**, bottom electrode **128** also completes formation of ferroelectric memory device **108**.

(115) In an embodiment, stack portion **108C** including one or more layers in the ferroelectric memory device **108** are also left as a spacer adjacent to sidewall **126A** of etch stop layer **126**. In different embodiments, the stack portion **108C** extends to various points along the sidewall **126A**. In at least one embodiment, the dielectric **136** is also recessed relative to uppermost surface **136A**, as indicated within the enhanced image in box **610** and by dashed lines **137** during patterning to form bottom electrode **128**.

(116) FIG. 6E is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. 6D following the process to deposit an encapsulation layer **114** on the ferroelectric memory devices **108**, on portion **108C**, and on the dielectric **136**. In an embodiment, the encapsulation layer **114** includes silicon and one or more of carbon, nitrogen and oxygen. The encapsulation layer **114** may be deposited by a PVD, PECVD, or an ALD process. In exemplary embodiments, the encapsulation layer **114** includes a material that is different from a material of the etch stop layer **126**. The encapsulation layer **114** may include a same elemental composition but differ in dopant concentrations. Differing dopant concentrations may enable etch stop layer **126** to have a higher etch selectivity relative to encapsulation layer **114**.

(117) The deposition process utilized to form encapsulation layer **114** may result in conformal deposition on uppermost surface **108B** and on sidewalls **108A** of the ferroelectric memory devices **108**. In other embodiments, the etch stop layer **126** may be wider at the uppermost surface **108B** and narrower at the base of the ferroelectric memory device **108**. The encapsulation layer **114** may be deposited to a thickness, $T_{sub,EC}$, between 5 nm and 30 nm. The thickness, $T_{sub,EC}$, depends on a maximum spacing, $S_{sub,M1}$, between adjacent ferroelectric memory devices **108**.

(118) FIG. 6F is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. 6E following the process to form a mask **611** on the encapsulation layer **114** to isolate each ferroelectric memory device **108**. As shown in mask **611** includes a mask portion **611A** at the interface between memory region **101A** and logic region **101B**. In an embodiment, the mask **611** is formed by a lithographic process and includes a photoresist material. The mask portion **611A** may be wider or narrower than depicted. In exemplary embodiments the mask portion **611A** may have a width, $W_{sub,K}$, that is sufficiently narrow to remove portion **108C**.

(119) Mask **611** may not be perfectly symmetric about each ferroelectric memory device **108**. An asymmetric mask may cause lateral portions of the encapsulation layer **114** to be disproportionate about sidewall **108A**. For example, some portions may be wider than others. However, the level of disproportionality may be preserved across each ferroelectric memory device **108**. Such

disproportionality is not expected to result in degradation to device performance.

(120) FIG. 7A is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. 6F following the process to etch the encapsulation layer **114**. In an embodiment, a plasma etch process is utilized to etch the encapsulation layer **114** selective to the etch stop layer **126**. As discussed above, the encapsulation layer **114** and the etch stop layer **126** may include materials that are similar, such as silicon nitride doped with impurities. Differences in dopant species may provide selectivity to etch stop layer **126** which etching encapsulation layer **114**. In at least one embodiment, the encapsulation layer **114** is removed from masked areas such as from sidewalls of stack portion **108C**, as will be discussed below.

(121) FIG. 7B is a plan-view illustration of the structure in FIG. 7A, in an embodiment where the conductive interconnects **102** are discrete islands and the mask forms a substantially circular encapsulation layer **114** around sidewall **108A** of ferroelectric memory device **108**. In other embodiments, the encapsulation layer **114** may be rectangular as indicated by dashed lines **114D**. A plan view profile of the ferroelectric memory device **108** can be independent of a plan view profile of the encapsulation layer **114**.

(122) FIG. 7D is a plan-view illustration of the structure in FIG. 7A, in an embodiment where the conductive interconnects **102** are trenches and the mask forms an encapsulation layer **114** around sidewall **108A** of ferroelectric memory device **108**. As shown, the encapsulation layer **114** also extends parallel to the conductive interconnects **102**, has a lateral extension LEX, and resembles the structure depicted in FIG. 2B.

(123) With reference to the encapsulation layer **114** in FIGS. 7B-7C, outermost sidewall **114A** of encapsulation layer **114** may not be perfectly symmetric about each ferroelectric memory device **108**. An asymmetric mask discussed above may cause lateral portions of the encapsulation layer **114** to be disproportionate about sidewall **108A**. For example, some portions may be wider than others. However, the level of disproportionality may be preserved across each ferroelectric memory device **108**. Such disproportionality is not expected to result in degradation to device performance.

(124) FIG. 8A is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. 7A following the process to form openings in a dielectric formed above the ferroelectric memory devices **108**. In an embodiment, a blanket deposition process is utilized to deposit a dielectric **138** on the encapsulation layer **114**, on the dielectric **136** and on the etch stop layer **126**. The deposition process may be carried out by a PVD, PECVD, or a chemical vapor deposition (CVD) process. The dielectric **138** may be planarized after deposition. A mask **613** may be formed on the dielectric **138** by a lithographic process. In an embodiment, openings **615** may be formed in the dielectric **138** by a plasma etch process. The etch process is continued the encapsulation layer **114** is completely etched above the ferroelectric memory device **108** in the openings **615**. Depending on embodiments discussed in FIGS. 1A, 1D, and 1E, the etch process is further continued to etch a hard mask (if present) and expose uppermost surface **108B** of each ferroelectric memory device **108**, or if not present, expose uppermost surface **108B** as illustrated. In at least one embodiment, the openings **615** are tapered. In other embodiments, the openings **615** are substantially vertical.

(125) A total depth of opening **615** is dependent on a vertical thickness, $T_{\text{sub.MD}}$, of the ferroelectric memory devices **108**. As shown, dielectric **138** has a thickness that is approximately equal to the vertical thickness, $T_{\text{sub.106}}$ of second level **106**. In other embodiments, where dielectric **136** is recessed as described in association with FIG. 6D, the dielectric **138** also extends below second level **106** into level **104**.

(126) FIG. 8B is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. 8A following the process to remove the mask **613** and deposit a conductive material to form via electrodes **116**. In an embodiment, one or more liner layers are formed in the opening **615** on the uppermost layer of ferroelectric memory device **108**. In at least one embodiment, a fill metal such as copper, tungsten, nickel, cobalt is deposited on a liner layer. The liner layer may include ruthenium or tantalum. A planarization process may be performed to remove the excess conductive material deposited on the

dielectric **138**. In an embodiment, the planarization process includes a chemical mechanical polish (CMP) process.

(127) FIG. **8C** is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. **8B** following the process to form a mask **617** on the dielectric **138**, and on the via electrodes **116**. The mask **617** is designed to form an interconnect structure in the logic region **101B**. In an embodiment, the mask **617** is formed by a lithographic process and includes a photoresist material.

(128) FIG. **8D** is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. **8C** following the process to etch the dielectric **138** to form trenches **619A** and **619B** in the logic region **101B**. In an embodiment, a plasma etch process is utilized to etch the dielectric **138** through openings in the mask **617** to form trenches **619A**, and **619B**. The dielectric **138** may be etched to a depth, $T_{\text{sub.H}}$ and a width, $W_{\text{sub.H}}$, that is determined by a thickness T_o , of dielectric **138** above the etch stop layer **126**. In embodiments, $T_{\text{sub.H}}$ and $W_{\text{sub.H}}$ range between 10 nm and 200 nm and between 10 nm and 50 nm, respectively. $W_{\text{sub.H}}$ is determined by a width of interconnect vias to be formed within the trench. A height difference between T_o and $T_{\text{sub.H}}$, of the remaining dielectric **138** (as measured from an uppermost surface of the etch stop layer **126**) may also be determined by a height and width of a via to be formed within trench **619B**. The height and width of a via is determined by a desired minimum line conductance of the via to be formed within trench **619B**.

(129) FIG. **8E** is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. **8D** following the process to etch the dielectric **138** to form a via within in the hanging trench in the logic region **101B**. In an embodiment, mask utilized to form trenches **619A** and **619B** is removed and a mask **621** is formed. In an embodiment, the mask **621** is formed by a lithographic process and includes a photoresist material. The mask **621** has an opening within trench **619A** that is designed to enable etching the dielectric **138** to form a via opening **619C** as shown. In at least one embodiment, mask **621** does not include an opening within trench **619A** in the plane of the Figure but may include an opening in a plane that is behind or in front. In an embodiment, a plasma etch process is utilized to form via opening **619C** by etching the dielectric **138** and etch stop layer **126**. An advantage of the process methodology outlined herein, is that etch stop layer **126** has a thickness $T_{\text{sub.EC}}$, that is determined by a deposition process and is unaltered by the formation of ferroelectric memory device **108** in the memory region **101A**. Formation of via opening **619C** within the stop layer **126** can be targeted and tuned by depositing the etch stop layer **126** to a desired thickness. In at least one embodiment, the formation of via opening **619C** exposes an uppermost surface **118A** of the conductive interconnect **118**.

(130) FIG. **8F** is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. **8E** following the process to remove the mask and deposit a conductive material into the openings to form via **124**, and metal lines **120** and **122**. Mask utilized to form via opening **619C** is removed and a conductive material is deposited into the trenches **619A**, **619B**, and via opening **619C**. In an embodiment, the conductive material includes a material that is the same or substantially the same as the material of the via electrode **116**, including embodiments with or without a liner layer and fill metal on liner layer. In at least one embodiment, a fill metal includes copper, tungsten, nickel or cobalt, and a liner layer includes ruthenium or tantalum. In some such embodiments, a liner layer is deposited on uppermost surface **118A** of the conductive interconnect **118**, on sidewalls of the etch stop layer **126**, dielectric **138**, on uppermost dielectric surface **138A** and on surfaces of via electrodes **116**. In other embodiments where no liner is implemented a fill metal or a conductive material is directly deposited on uppermost surface **118A** of the conductive interconnect **118**, on sidewalls of the etch stop layer **126**, dielectric **138**, on uppermost dielectric surface **138A** and on surfaces of via electrodes **116**.

(131) A planarization process may be utilized to remove an excess conductive material deposited on dielectric **138** and on via electrodes **116**. In an embodiment, the planarization process includes a chemical mechanical polish (CMP) process. The CMP process isolates metal line **120** from metal line **122**. Via **124** is formed at the same time as metal line **122**.

(132) In at least one embodiment, uppermost surfaces **116A** of via electrode **116** and uppermost surfaces **120A** and **122A** of metal lines are co-planar or substantially co-planar after the CMP process.

(133) In general, via electrodes **116** may be fabricated before or after fabrication of via **124** and metal line **122**. The method described in association with FIGS. **8A-F** can be performed so as to fabricate via **124** and metal line **122** prior to fabrication of via electrode **116**.

(134) In other embodiments, such as is illustrated in FIG. **16A**, opening **615**, and trenches **619A** and **619B** can be formed simultaneously. In some such embodiments, openings **615**, and trenches **619A** and **619B** can have a substantially same depth $D_{sub.H}$ as shown. $D_{sub.H}$ is less than a total depth $T_{sub.O}$ of the dielectric **138**, as shown. Trenches **619A** and **619B** have a width, $W_{sub.H}$. $W_{sub.H}$ can be the same or different for trenches **619A** and **619B**. In an embodiment, a first plasma etch is utilized to etch dielectric **138** selective to encapsulation layer **114**, and a second plasma etch that is selective to dielectric **138** is utilized to etch encapsulation layer **114**. In at least one embodiment, depending on thicknesses of dielectric **138** and encapsulation layer **114**, $D_{sub.H}$ in the logic region **101B** can be greater by up to 5% compared to $D_{sub.H}$ in the memory region **101A**.

(135) The process can be continued to form mask **621** that covers openings **615** and portions of trenches **619A** and **619B**, as shown in FIG. **16B**. A plasma etch process described in association with FIG. **8E** may be performed to form opening **619C**. The plasma etch etches an entire thickness $T_{sub.EC}$ and exposes uppermost surface **118A**. In at least one embodiment, mask **621** can be removed after formation of openings **615**, and trenches **619A** and **619B** as shown in FIG. **16C**.

(136) The process can be continued to fill openings **615**, trenches **619A** and **619B**, and opening **619C** as shown in FIG. **16D**. The process to fill openings **615**, and trenches **619A** and **619B** and form via electrodes **116**, via **124** and metal lines **120** and **122** is the same or substantially the same as the method described in association with FIG. **8F**.

(137) FIG. **9A** is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. **6F**, following a process to etch the encapsulation layer **114**, to remove or reduce a thickness of portion **108C**. In at least one embodiment, the mask portion **611A** (dashed box) has been removed to facilitate easier removal of encapsulation layer **114** from above the stack portion **108C** and for removal of the stack portion **108C** in a subsequent processing operation.

(138) In at least one embodiment, a plasma etch is utilized to etch the encapsulation layer **114** selectively with respect to etch stop layer **126** and dielectric **136**.

(139) FIG. **9B** is a cross-sectional illustration of the structure in FIG. **6E** following the process to form a mask **623** that covers a substantial portion of the memory region **101A** and following a process to etch and remove the encapsulation layer **114** everywhere not covered by the mask **623**. In at least one embodiment, the mask **623** exposes the logic region **101B**. As shown, a plasma etch process is utilized to etch the encapsulation layer **114**, as described in association with FIG. **7A**. Referring again to FIG. **9B**, the encapsulation layer remains in the memory region **101A**, adjacent to stack portion **108C** and over the dielectric **136**. The encapsulation layer **114** extends continuously between each ferroelectric memory device **108**, as shown in FIG. **3**.

(140) In other embodiments, stack portion **108C**, adjacent to the sidewall **126A**, can be removed by an etch process, after removal of the encapsulation layer **114**.

(141) FIG. **10** illustrates computing architecture **1000** with a coherent cache or memory-side buffer chiplet that includes a memory controller, wherein the coherent cache or memory-side buffer chiplet is coupled to an accelerator, a processor, and a memory, in accordance with at least one embodiment. Computing architecture **1000** comprises coherent cache or memory-side buffer chiplet **1001**, accelerator **1002** (e.g., inference chip), processor **1020** (e.g., central processing unit), and memory die **1004**. In at least one embodiment, coherent cache or memory-side buffer chiplet **1001** comprises at least two channels **1015** which are configured to connect with accelerator **1002** and processor **1020**. In at least one embodiment, coherent cache or memory-side buffer chiplet

1001 comprises I/O and controller **1010** to manage data traffic with memory die **1004**. By moving controller **1010** from processor **1020** to coherent cache or memory-side buffer chiplet **1001**, cost in terms of power and die area for processor **1020** is reduced. In at least one embodiment, coherent cache or memory-side buffer chiplet **1001** is a cache memory that comprises ferroelectric memory cells. For example, coherent cache or memory-side buffer chiplet **1001** comprises one or more of: FE-SRAM, FE-DRAM, SRAM, MRAM, resistance RAM (Re-RAM), embedded DRAM (e.g., 1T-1C based memory), or a combination of them. Using FE-SRAM, MRAM, or Re-RAM allows for low power and high-speed memory operation.

(142) FIG. **11** illustrates architecture **1100** of the coherent cache or memory-side buffer chiplet (e.g., **1107**) with multiple controllers and multiple cache banks, in accordance with at least one embodiment. In at least one embodiment, architecture **1100** comprises channels (e.g., ch0 **1115-1** and ch1 **1115-2**), cache banks **1101**, local cache controller **1102**, non-volatile (NV) controller **1103**, and reliability logic **1104**. Coherent cache or memory-side buffer chiplet **1107** may function as a cache or memory buffer. In at least one embodiment, cache lookups can map a large physical memory into a small physical cache through the use of indirection via tags. Here, indirection refers to the use of tags to specify which address maps to which physical location. If multiple addresses can map to a physical location, a tag is used to figure out which address is currently mapped.

(143) In at least one embodiment, each cache bank **1101** includes data bank **1105** (e.g., comprising memory cells) and associated tags **1106**. In at least one embodiment, data bank **1105** comprises ferroelectric memory cells. In at least one embodiment, data bank **1105** comprises one or more of: FE-SRAM, FE-DRAM, SRAM, MRAM, resistance RAM (Re-RAM), embedded DRAM (e.g., 1T-1C based memory), or a combination of them. Using FE-SRAM, MRAM, or Re-RAM allows for low power and high-speed memory operation. In at least one embodiment, when data bank **1105** includes ferroelectric memory, it uses NV controller **1103** and a stronger reliability logic (e.g., error correction code) for security compared to non-ferroelectric memory for data bank **1105**.

(144) When data bank **1105** is used to implement a cache, tags may be used to identify which addresses map to which physical locations in the bank. The cache may be set associative in which a particular address can map to several physical locations. The specific physical location a newly allocated address is mapped to may be determined by a replacement algorithm such as LRU (least recently used) or pseudo-LRU, or even random. On the other hand, the cache might be direct mapped, with each address mapping to merely a physical cache line. In both set associative and direct mapped caches, several addresses map to a physical cache line. To identify the address currently occupying the physical cache line, a tag **1106** may be coupled with each physical line. Tag **1106** may comprise some address bits, sufficient to uniquely identify which address currently occupies the physical line coupled with the tag.

(145) In at least one embodiment, cache controller **1102** could be used to control state transitions required for cache look ups such as comparing requested addresses with tags stored in the tag **1106**, and identifying a candidate for replacement (replacement algorithm) when a cache miss occurs. In addition, the cache controller could be tasked with initializing the cache when the cache powers on. When FE memory of data bank **1105**, which retains state across power cycles, is used, cache controller **1102** could write 0s to all memory locations to ensure that data associated with previously executed programs is erased, preventing any data leakage to subsequently executed programs. The non-volatile memory may also include an NV bit, which could indicate that cache data is meant to be non-volatile and remain across power cycles. Cache controller **1102** would skip locations marked thus when initializing memory.

(146) In at least one embodiment, reliability logic **1104** performs error correction to the data. Any suitable error correction scheme (e.g., with error correction code (ECC)) may be used by reliability logic **1104**. In at least one embodiment, NV controller **1103** is provided to explicitly clear the cache when using a non-volatile memory, such as FM memory for data bank **1105**. NV controller **1103**

may include an NV bit which indicates cache lines that should not be cleared but are expected to retain their contents across power cycles. The functions of NV controller **1103** can be combined in cache controller **1102**, or vice versa.

(147) FIG. **12** illustrates apparatus **1200** comprising memory and corresponding logic, wherein the memory comprises ferroelectric (FE) memory bit-cells, in accordance with at least one embodiment. Apparatus **1200** comprises M×N memory array **1201** of bit-cells, logic circuitry **1202** for address decoding, sense amplifier and write drivers **1203**, and plate-line (PL) driver **1204**. Logic circuitry **1202** comprises address decoders for selecting a row of bit-cells and/or a particular bit-cell from M×N memory array **1201**, where M and N are integers of same or different values. Write drivers **1203** comprises sense-amplifiers for reading the values from the selected bit-cell, while write drivers are used to write a particular value to a selected bit-cell. Here, a schematic of FE bit-cell **1201.sub.0,0** is illustrated. The same embodiments apply to other bit-cells of the M×N array. In this example, a one-transistor one-capacitor (1T1C) bit cell is shown, but the embodiments are applicable to 1TnC bit-cell and multi-element FE gain bit-cell as described herein.

(148) In at least one embodiment, bit-cell **1201.sub.0,0** comprises a word-line (WL), a plate-line (PL), a bit-line (BL), a complementary bit-line (BLB), and two half bit-cells **1201.sub.0,0_A** and **1201.sub.0,0_B**. In at least one embodiment, bit-cell **1201.sub.0,0** comprises an n-type transistor MN1, and FE capacitive structure Cfe.sub.1. The gates of transistor MN1 are coupled to a common WL. In various embodiments, one terminal of the FE capacitive structure Cfe.sub.1 is coupled to a PL. The second terminal of the FE capacitive structure is coupled to source or drain terminal of the transistor MN.sub.1. In various embodiments, BL is coupled to the source or drain terminal of first transistor MN.sub.1. In at least one embodiment, a BL capacitor CB1.sub.1 is coupled to the source or drain terminal of first transistor MN.sub.1 and to a reference node (e.g., ground such that the FE capacitor is not coupled to the same source or drain terminal. In at least one embodiment, the PL is parallel to the BL and orthogonal to the WL. In at least one embodiment, the PL is parallel to the WL and orthogonal to the BL.

(149) In at least one embodiment, the FE capacitor is a planar capacitor. In at least one embodiment, the FE capacitor is a pillar or non-planar capacitor. In at least one embodiment, when the bit-cell is a 1TnC bit-cell, the FE capacitors are configured in a tower structure allowing the x-y foot-print to remain the same as for a 1T1C bit-cell but with taller bit-cell in the z-direction. In at least one embodiment, when the bit-cell is a multi-element FE gain bit-cell, the bit-cell allows for decoupling of the storage node from BL, allows for reducing the thickness scaling requirement for pillar capacitors, and allows for reducing polarization density requirements. Further, by stacking the 'n' capacitors in the z-direction (forming a tower), the area increases in the x-y direction due to the two transistors. The increase in area (due to the two transistors per bit-cell) allows for expanding the sizes (or radius) of the capacitors in the x-y direction.

(150) FIG. **13** illustrates a high-level architecture of an artificial intelligence (AI) machine **1300** comprising a compute die positioned on top of a memory die, in accordance with at least one embodiment. AI machine **1300** comprises computational block **1301** or processor having random-access memory (RAM) **1302** and compute die **1303**; first random-access memory **1304** (e.g., static RAM (SRAM), ferroelectric or paraelectric RAM (FeRAM), ferroelectric or paraelectric static random-access memory (FeSRAM)), main processor **1305**, second random-access memory **1306** (dynamic RAM (DRAM), FeRAM), and solid-state memory or drive (SSD) **1307**. In at least one embodiment, some or all components of AI machine **1300** are packaged in a package forming a system-on-chip (SoC). The SoC can be configured as a logic-on-logic configuration, which can be in a 3D configuration or a 2.5D configuration.

(151) In at least one embodiment, computational block **1301** is packaged in a package and then coupled to processor **1305** and first random-access memory **1304**, second random-access memory **1306**, and SSD **1307** on a printed circuit board (PCB). In at least one embodiment, computational block **1301** is configured as a logic-on-logic configuration, which can be in a 3D configuration or a

2.5D configuration. In at least one embodiment, computational block **1301** comprises a special purpose compute die **1303** or microprocessor. For example, compute die **1303** is a compute chiplet that performs a function of an accelerator or inference. In at least one embodiment, RAM **1302** is DRAM which forms a special memory/cache for the special purpose compute die **1303**. The DRAM can be embedded DRAM (eDRAM) such as 1T-1C (one transistor and one capacitor) based memories. In at least one embodiment, RAM **1302** is ferroelectric or paraelectric RAM (Fe-RAM).

(152) In at least one embodiment, compute die **1303** is specialized for applications such as Artificial Intelligence, graph processing, and algorithms for data processing. In at least one embodiment, compute die **1303** further has logic computational blocks, for example, for multipliers and buffers, a special data memory block (e.g., buffers) comprising DRAM, FeRAM, or a combination of them. In at least one embodiment, RAM **1302** has weights and inputs stored in-order to improve the computational efficiency. The interconnects between processor **1305** (also referred to as special purpose processor), first random-access memory **1304** and compute die **1303** are optimized for high bandwidth and low latency. The architecture of FIG. **13** allows efficient packaging to lower the energy, power, or cost and provides for ultra-high bandwidth between RAM **1302** and compute chiplet **1303** of computational **1301**.

(153) In at least one embodiment, RAM **1302** is partitioned to store input data (or data to be processed) **1302a** and weight factors **1302b**. In at least one embodiment, input data **1302a** is stored in a separate memory (e.g., a separate memory die) and weight factors **1302b** are stored in a separate memory (e.g., separate memory die).

(154) In at least one embodiment, computational logic or compute die **1303** comprises matrix multiplier, adder, concatenation logic, buffers, and combinational logic. In various embodiments, compute die **1303** performs multiplication operation on input data **1302a** and weight factors **1302b**. In at least one embodiment, weight factors **1302b** are fixed weights. For example, processor **1305** (e.g., a graphics processor unit (GPU), field programmable grid array (FPGA) processor, application specific integrated circuit (ASIC) processor, digital signal processor (DSP), an AI processor, a central processing unit (CPU), or any other high-performance processor) computes the weights for a training model. Once the weights are computed, they are stored in RAM **1302**. In various embodiments, the input data that is to be analyzed using a trained model, is processed by computational block **1301** with computed weight factors **1302b** to generate an output (e.g., a classification result).

(155) In at least one embodiment, first random-access memory **1304** is ferroelectric or paraelectric based SRAM. For example, a six transistor (6T) SRAM bit-cells having ferroelectric or paraelectric transistors are used to implement a non-volatile FeSRAM. In at least one embodiment, SSD **1307** comprises NAND flash cells. In at least one embodiment, SSD **1307** comprises NOR flash cells. In at least one embodiment, SSD **1307** comprises multi-threshold NAND flash cells.

(156) In various embodiments, the non-volatility of FeRAM is used to introduce new features such as security, functional safety, and faster reboot time of architecture of AI machine **1300**. The non-volatile FeRAM is a low power RAM that provides fast access to data and weights. First random-access memory **1304** can also serve as a fast storage for inference die **1301** (or accelerator), which typically has low capacity and fast access requirements.

(157) In various embodiments, the FeRAM (FeDRAM or FeSRAM) includes ferroelectric or paraelectric material. The ferroelectric or paraelectric (FE) material may be in a transistor gate stack or in a capacitor of the memory. The ferroelectric material can be any suitable low voltage FE material that allows the FE material to switch its state by a low voltage (e.g., 1300 mV). Threshold in the FE material has a highly non-linear transfer function in the polarization vs. voltage response. The threshold is related a) non-linearity of switching transfer function, and b) to the squareness of the FE switching. The non-linearity of switching transfer function is the width of the derivative of the polarization vs. voltage plot. The squareness is defined by the ratio of the remnant polarization to the saturation polarization; perfect squareness will show a value of 1.

(158) The squareness of the FE switching can be suitably manipulated with chemical substitution. For example, in PbTiO_3 a P-E (polarization-electric field) square loop can be modified by La or Nb substitution to create an S-shaped loop. The shape can be systematically tuned to ultimately yield a non-linear dielectric. The squareness of the FE switching can also be changed by the granularity of a FE layer. A perfectly epitaxial, crystalline FE layer will show higher squareness (e.g., ratio is closer to 1) compared to a poly crystalline FE. This perfect epitaxial can be accomplished using lattice matched bottom and top electrodes. In one example, BiFeO_3 (BFO) can be epitaxially synthesized using a lattice matched SrRuO_3 bottom electrode yielding P-E loops that are square. Progressive doping with La will reduce the squareness.

(159) In at least one embodiment, the FE material comprises a perovskite of the type ABO_3 , where 'A' and 'B' are two cations of different sizes, and 'O' is oxygen which is an anion that bonds to both the cations. Generally, the size of atoms of A is larger than the size of B atoms. In at least one embodiment, the perovskite can be doped (e.g., by La or lanthanides). In various embodiments, when the FE material is a perovskite, the conductive oxides are of the type AA'BB'O_3 . A' is a dopant for atomic site A, it can be an element from the lanthanides series. B' is a dopant for atomic site B, it can be an element from the transition metal elements especially Sc, Ti, V, Cr, Mn, Fe, Co, Ni, Cu, Zn. A' may have the same valency of site A, with a different ferroelectric polarizability.

(160) In at least one embodiment, the FE material comprises hexagonal ferroelectrics of the type h-RMnO_3 , where R is a rare earth element which includes one of cerium (Ce), dysprosium (Dy), erbium (Er), europium (Eu), gadolinium (Gd), holmium (Ho), lanthanum (La), lutetium (Lu), neodymium (Nd), praseodymium (Pr), promethium (Pm), samarium (Sm), scandium (Sc), terbium (Tb), thulium (Tm), ytterbium (Yb), and yttrium (Y). The ferroelectric phase is characterized by a buckling of the layered MnO_5 polyhedra, accompanied by displacements of the Y ions, which lead to a net electric polarization. In at least one embodiment, hexagonal FE includes one of: YMnO_3 or LuFeO_3 . In various embodiments, when the FE material comprises hexagonal ferroelectrics, the conductive oxides are of $\text{A}_{0.2}\text{O}_{0.3}$ (e.g., $\text{In}_{0.2}\text{O}_{0.3}$, $\text{Fe}_{0.2}\text{O}_{0.3}$) and ABO_3 type, where 'A' is a rare earth element and B is Mn.

(161) In at least one embodiment, the FE material is perovskite, which includes one or more of: La, Sr, Co, Ru, Y, Ba, Cu, Bi, Ca, and Ni. For example, metallic perovskites such as: $(\text{La,Sr})\text{CoO}_3$, SrRuO_3 , $(\text{La,Sr})\text{MnO}_3$, $\text{YBa}_{0.2}\text{Cu}_{0.3}\text{O}_{0.7}$, $\text{BiSr}_{0.2}\text{CaCu}_{0.2}\text{O}_{0.8}$, LaNiO_3 , etc., may be used for FE material. Perovskites can be suitably doped to achieve a spontaneous distortion in a range of 0.3 to 2%. For chemically substituted BiFeO_3 , BrCrO_3 , BuCoO_3 class of materials, La or rare earth substitution into the Bi site can tune the spontaneous distortion. In at least one embodiment, the FE material is contacted with a conductive metal oxide that includes one of the conducting perovskite metallic oxides exemplified by: La—Sr—CoO_3 , SrRuO_3 , La—Sr—MnO_3 , $\text{YBa}_{0.2}\text{Cu}_{0.3}\text{O}_{0.7}$, $\text{Bi}_{0.2}\text{Sr}_{0.2}\text{CaCu}_{0.2}\text{O}_{0.8}$, and LaNiO_3 .

(162) In at least one embodiment, the FE material comprises a stack of layers including low voltage FE material between conductive oxides. In various embodiments, when the FE material is a perovskite, the conductive oxides are of the type AA'BB'O_3 . A' is a dopant for atomic site A, it can be an element from the lanthanides series. B' is a dopant for atomic site B, it can be an element from the transition metal elements especially Sc, Ti, V, Cr, Mn, Fe, Co, Ni, Cu, Zn. A' may have the same valency of site A, with a different ferroelectric polarizability. In various embodiments, when metallic perovskite is used for the FE material, the conductive oxides can include one or more of: IrO_2 , RuO_2 , PdO_2 , OsO_2 , or ReO_3 . In at least one embodiment, the perovskite is doped with La or lanthanides. In at least one embodiment, thin layer (e.g., approximately 10 nm) perovskite template conductors such as SrRuO_3 coated on top of IrO_2 , RuO_2 , PdO_2 , PtO_2 , which have a non-perovskite structure but higher conductivity to provide a seed or template for the growth of pure perovskite ferroelectric at low temperatures, are used as the conductive oxides.

(163) In at least one embodiment, ferroelectric materials are doped with s-orbital material (e.g., materials for first period, second period, and ionic third and fourth periods). In at least one embodiment, f-orbital materials (e.g., lanthanides) are doped to the ferroelectric material to make paraelectric material. Examples of room temperature paraelectric materials include: SrTiO_3 , $\text{Ba}_{1-x}\text{Sr}_x\text{TiO}_3$ (where x is -0.05 , and y is 0.95), HfZrO_2 , Hf—Si—O .

(164) In at least one embodiment, the FE material comprises one or more of: hafnium (Hf), zirconium (Zr), aluminum (Al), silicon (Si), their oxides or their alloyed oxides. In at least one embodiment, the FE material includes one or more of: $\text{Al}_{1-x}\text{Sc}_x\text{N}$, $\text{Ga}_{1-x}\text{Sc}_x\text{N}$, $\text{Al}_{1-x}\text{Y}_x\text{N}$ or $\text{Al}_{1-x-y}\text{Mg}_x\text{Nb}_y\text{N}$, y doped HfO_2 , where x includes one of: Al, Ca, Ce, Dy, Er, Gd, Ge, La, Sc, Si, Sr, Sn, or Y, wherein 'x' is a fraction. In at least one embodiment, the FE material includes one or more of: bismuth ferrite (BFO), or BFO with doping material.

(165) In at least one embodiment, the FE material includes bismuth ferrite (BFO), BFO with a first doping material where in the first doping material is one of lanthanum, or any element from the lanthanide series of the periodic table. In at least one embodiment, the FE material includes a relaxor ferro-electric includes one of barium titanium-bismuth zinc niobium tantalum (BT-BZNT) or barium titanium-barium strontium titanium (BT-BST).

(166) In at least one embodiment, the FE material includes hafnium oxides of the form, $\text{Hf}_{1-x}\text{E}_x\text{O}_y$ where E can be Al, Ca, Ce, Dy, Er, Gd, Ge, La, Sc, Si, Sr, Sn, or Y. In at least one embodiment, the FE material includes niobate type compounds LiNbO_3 , LiTaO_3 , lithium iron tantalum oxy fluoride, barium strontium niobate, sodium barium niobate, or potassium strontium niobate.

(167) In at least one embodiment, the FE material comprises multiple layers. For example, alternating layers of $[\text{Bi}_2\text{O}_2]^{2+}$, and pseudo-perovskite blocks ($\text{Bi}_4\text{Ti}_3\text{O}_{12}$ and related Aurivillius phases), with perovskite layers that are n octahedral layers in thickness can be used. In at least one embodiment, the FE material comprises organic material. For example, polyvinylidene fluoride or polyvinylidene difluoride (PVDF).

(168) In at least one embodiment, the FE material comprises hexagonal ferroelectrics of the type h-RMnO_3 , where R is a rare earth element which includes one of cerium (Ce), dysprosium (Dy), erbium (Er), europium (Eu), gadolinium (Gd), holmium (Ho), lanthanum (La), lutetium (Lu), neodymium (Nd), praseodymium (Pr), promethium (Pm), samarium (Sm), scandium (Sc), terbium (Tb), thulium (Tm), ytterbium (Yb), and yttrium (Y). The ferroelectric phase is characterized by a buckling of the layered MnO_5 polyhedra, accompanied by displacements of the Y ions, which lead to a net electric polarization. In at least one embodiment, hexagonal FE includes one of: YMnO_3 or LuFeO_3 . In various embodiments, when the FE material comprises hexagonal ferroelectrics, the conductive oxides are of A_2O_3 (e.g., In_2O_3 , Fe_2O_3) and ABO_3 type, where 'A' is a rare earth element and B is Mn.

(169) In at least one embodiment, the FE material comprises improper FE material. An improper ferroelectric is a ferroelectric where the primary order parameter is an order mechanism such as strain or buckling of the atomic order. Examples of improper FE material are LuFeO_3 class of materials or super lattice of ferroelectric and paraelectric materials SnTiO_3 (STO), respectively, and LaAlO_3 (LAO) and STO, respectively. For example, a super lattice of $[\text{PTO}/\text{STO}]_n$ or $[\text{LAO}/\text{STO}]_n$, where 'n' is between 1 to 1300. While various embodiments here are described with reference to ferroelectric material for storing the charge state, the embodiments are also applicable for paraelectric material. In at least one embodiment, paraelectric material includes one of: SrTiO_3 , $\text{Ba}_{1-x}\text{Sr}_x\text{TiO}_3$, HfZrO_2 , Hf—Si—O .

(170) The method of forming the structures described herein are applicable to various logic embodiments. For example, the FeRAM devices or capacitive structures formed herein can be used to form other ferroelectric/paraelectric circuits. These circuits can be implemented as majority gate, minority gate and/or threshold gate.

(171) Following examples are provided that illustrate the various embodiments. The examples can be combined with other examples. As such, various embodiments can be combined with other embodiments without changing the scope of the invention.

(172) FIG. 14 illustrates 3-input majority gate 1400 using non-linear input capacitors, in accordance with at least one embodiment. In at least one embodiment, 3-input majority gate 1400 comprises non-linear input capacitors C1n1, C2n1, and C3n1 that receives digital signals a, b, and c, respectively. Here, signal names and node names are interchangeably used. For example, 'a' refers to node 'a' or signal 'a' depending on the context of the sentence. One end or terminal of capacitor C1n1 is coupled to node a while the other end of capacitor C1n1 is coupled to summing node Vs. The same is true for other non-linear capacitors C2n1 and C3n1 as shown. In at least one embodiment, 3-input majority gate 1400 comprises a driver circuitry 1401. In this example, driver circuitry 1401 is an inverter. In other embodiments, other types of driver circuitries can be used such as NAND gate, NOR gate, multiplexer, buffer, and other logic gates. The majority function is performed at summing node Vs as Majority (a,b,c). In this example, since driver circuitry 1401 is an inverter, minority function is performed at output "out" as Minority (a,b,c).

(173) In at least one embodiment, in addition to the gate capacitance of driver circuitry 1401, an additional linear capacitor CL is coupled to summing node Vs and ground as shown. In at least one embodiment, this linear capacitor CL is a non-ferroelectric capacitor. In at least one embodiment, the non-ferroelectric capacitor includes one of: dielectric capacitor, paraelectric capacitor, or non-linear dielectric capacitor. A dielectric capacitor comprises first and second metal plates with a dielectric between them. Examples of such dielectrics are: HfO.sub.x, ABO.sub.3 perovskites, nitrides, oxy-fluorides, oxides, etc. A para-electric capacitor comprises first and second metal plates with a para-electric material between them. In at least one embodiment, f-orbital materials (e.g., lanthanides) are doped to the ferroelectric materials to make paraelectric material. Examples of room temperature paraelectric material include: SrTiO.sub.3, Ba.sub.(x)Sr.sub.(y)TiO.sub.3, HfZrO.sub.2, Hf—Si—O, La-substituted PbTiO.sub.3, PMN-PT based relaxor ferroelectrics. A dielectric capacitor comprises first and second metal plates with non-linear dielectric capacitor between them. The range for dielectric constant is 1.2 to 10000. The capacitor CL can be implemented as MIM (metal-insulator-metal) capacitor technology, transistor gate capacitor, hybrid of metal capacitors or transistor capacitor. The capacitor CL can be implemented as MIM (metal-insulator-metal) capacitor technology, transistor gate capacitor, or hybrid of metal capacitors or transistor capacitor.

(174) In at least one embodiment, the non-linear input capacitors C1n1, C2n1, and C3n1 comprise non-linear polar material. In at least one embodiment, the non-linear polar material includes one of: ferroelectric (FE) material, para-electric material, relaxor ferroelectric, or non-linear dielectric. In various embodiments, para-electric material is the same as FE material but with chemical doping of the active ferroelectric ion by an ion with no polar distortion. In some cases, the non-polar ions are non-s orbital ions formed with p, d, f external orbitals. In at least one embodiment, non-linear dielectric materials are same as para-electric materials, relaxors, and dipolar glasses.

(175) In at least one embodiment, f-orbital materials (e.g., lanthanides) are doped to the ferroelectric material to make paraelectric material. Examples of room temperature paraelectric material include: SrTiO.sub.3, Ba.sub.(x)Sr.sub.(y)TiO.sub.3, HfZrO.sub.2, Hf—Si—O.

(176) In various embodiments, the FE material can be any suitable low voltage FE material that allows the FE material to switch its state by a low voltage (e.g., 100 mV). In at least one embodiment, the FE material comprises a perovskite of the type ABO.sub.3, where 'A' and 'B' are two cations of different sizes, and 'O' is oxygen which is an anion that bonds to both the cations. Generally, the size of A atoms is larger than the size of B atoms. In at least one embodiment, the perovskite can be doped (e.g., by La or lanthanides). Perovskites can be suitably doped to achieve a spontaneous distortion in a range of 0.3 to 2%. For example, for chemically substituted lead titanate such as Zr in Ti site; La, Nb in Ti site, the concentration of these substitutes is such that it

achieves the spontaneous distortion in the range of 0.3 to 2%. For chemically substituted BiFeO_3 , BiCrO_3 , BiCoO_3 class of materials, La or rare earth substitution into the Bi site can tune the spontaneous distortion. In at least one embodiment, perovskite includes one of: BaTiO_3 , KNbO_3 , or NaTaO_3 .

(177) Threshold in the FE material has a highly non-linear transfer function in the polarization vs. voltage response. The threshold is related to: a) non-linearity of switching transfer function; and b) the squareness of the FE switching. The non-linearity of switching transfer function is the width of the derivative of the polarization vs. voltage plot. The squareness is defined by the ratio of the remnant polarization to the saturation polarization; perfect squareness will show a value of 1.

(178) The squareness of the FE switching can be suitably manipulated with chemical substitution. For example, in PbTiO_3 a P-E (polarization-electric field) square loop can be modified by La or Nb substitution to create an S-shaped loop. The shape can be systematically tuned to ultimately yield a non-linear dielectric. The squareness of the FE switching can also be changed by the granularity of the FE layer. A perfect epitaxial, crystalline FE layer will show higher squareness (e.g., ratio is closer to 1) compared to a poly crystalline FE. This perfect epitaxial can be accomplished by the use of lattice matched bottom and top electrodes. In one example, BiFeO_3 (BFO) can be epitaxially synthesized using a lattice matched SrRuO_3 bottom electrode yielding P-E loops that are square. Progressive doping with La will reduce the squareness.

(179) In at least one embodiment, the FE material is contacted with a conductive metal oxide that includes one of the conducting perovskite metallic oxides exemplified by: La-Sr-CoO_3 , SrRuO_3 , La-Sr-MnO_3 , $\text{YBa}_2\text{Cu}_3\text{O}_{7-x}$, $\text{Bi}_2\text{Sr}_2\text{CaCu}_2\text{O}_{14}$, LaNiO_3 , and ReO_3 .

(180) In at least one embodiment, the FE material comprises a stack of layers including low voltage FE material between conductive oxides. In various embodiments, when FE material is a perovskite, the conductive oxides are of the type $\text{AA}'\text{BB}'\text{O}_3$. A' is a dopant for atomic site A, it can be an element from the lanthanides series. B' is a dopant for atomic site B, it can be an element from the transition metal elements especially Sc, Ti, V, Cr, Mn, Fe, Co, Ni, Cu, Zn. A' may have the same valency of site A, with a different ferroelectric polarizability.

(181) In at least one embodiment, the FE material comprises hexagonal ferroelectrics of the type h-RMnO_3 , where R is a rare earth element such as: cerium (Ce), dysprosium (Dy), erbium (Er), europium (Eu), gadolinium (Gd), holmium (Ho), lanthanum (La), lutetium (Lu), neodymium (Nd), praseodymium (Pr), promethium (Pm), samarium (Sm), scandium (Sc), terbium (Tb), thulium (Tm), ytterbium (Yb), and yttrium (Y). The ferroelectric phase is characterized by a buckling of the layered MnO_5 polyhedra, accompanied by displacements of the Y ions, which lead to a net electric polarization. In at least one embodiment, hexagonal FE includes one of: YMnO_3 or LuFeO_3 . In various embodiments, when the FE material comprises hexagonal ferroelectrics, the conductive oxides adjacent to the FE material are of A_2O_3 (e.g., In_2O_3 , Fe_2O_3) and AB_2O_3 type, where 'A' is a rare earth element and B is Mn.

(182) In at least one embodiment, FE material comprises improper FE material. An improper ferroelectric is a ferroelectric where the primary order parameter is an order mechanism such as strain or buckling of the atomic order. Examples of improper FE material are LuFeO_3 class of materials or super lattice of ferroelectric and paraelectric materials. While various embodiments here are described with reference to ferroelectric material for storing the charge state, the embodiments are also applicable for paraelectric material. For example, the capacitor of various embodiments can be formed using paraelectric material instead of ferroelectric material.

(183) In at least one embodiment, the FE material includes one of: hafnium (Hf), zirconium (Zr), aluminum (Al), silicon (Si), their oxides or their alloyed oxides. In at least one embodiment, FE material includes one of: $\text{Al}_{1-x}\text{Sc}_x\text{N}$, $\text{Ga}_{1-x}\text{Sc}_x\text{N}$, $\text{Al}_{1-x}\text{Y}_x\text{N}$ or $\text{Al}_{1-x-y}\text{Mg}_x\text{Nb}_y\text{N}$, y doped HfO_2 , where x includes one of: Al, Ca, Ce, Dy, Er, Gd, Ge, La, Sc, Si, Sr, Sn, or Y, wherein 'x' is a fraction. In at least one embodiment, the FE

material includes bismuth ferrite (BFO) or BFO with doping material.

(184) In at least one embodiment, the FE material includes bismuth ferrite (BFO), BFO with a first doping material where in the first doping material is one of lanthanum, or any element from the lanthanide series of the periodic table. In at least one embodiment, the FE material includes a relaxor ferroelectric including one of barium titanium-bismuth zinc niobium tantalum (BT-BZNT), or barium titanium-barium strontium titanium (BT-BST).

(185) In at least one embodiment, the FE material includes hafnium oxides of the form, $\text{Hf.sub.(1-x)E.sub.(x)Q.sub.y}$ where E can be Al, Ca, Ce, Dy, Er, Gd, Ge, La, Sc, Si, Sr, Sn, or Y. In at least one embodiment, FE material includes niobate type compounds LiNbO.sub.3 , LiTaO.sub.3 , lithium iron tantalum oxy fluoride, barium strontium niobate, sodium barium niobate, or potassium strontium niobate.

(186) In at least one embodiment, the FE material comprises multiple layers. For example, alternating layers of $[\text{Bi.sub.2O.sub.2}]^{2+}$, and pseudo-perovskite blocks ($\text{Bi.sub.4Ti.sub.3O.sub.12}$ and related Aurivillius phases), with perovskite layers that are n octahedral layers in thickness can be used.

(187) In at least one embodiment, the FE material comprises organic material. For example, polyvinylidene fluoride or polyvinylidene difluoride (PVDF). The FE material is between two electrodes. These electrodes are conducting electrodes. In at least one embodiment, the electrodes are perovskite templated conductors. In such a templated structure, a thin layer (e.g., approximately 10 nm) of a perovskite conductor (such as SrRuO.sub.3) is coated on top of IrO.sub.2 , RuO.sub.2 , PdO.sub.2 , or PtO.sub.2 (which have a non-perovskite structure but higher conductivity) to provide a seed or template for the growth of pure perovskite ferroelectric at low temperatures. In at least one embodiment, when the ferroelectric comprises hexagonal ferroelectric material, the electrodes can have hexagonal metals, spinels, or cubic metals. Examples of hexagonal metals include: PtCoO.sub.2 , PdCoO.sub.2 , and other delafossite structured hexagonal metallic oxides such as Al-doped ZnO. Examples of spinels include Fe.sub.3O.sub.4 and LiV.sub.2O.sub.4 . Examples of cubic metals include indium tin oxide (ITO) such as Sn-doped In.sub.2O.sub.3 .

(188) The charge developed on node Vs produces a voltage and current that is the output of 3-input majority gate **1400**. Any suitable driver circuitry **1401** can drive this output. For example, a non-FE logic, FE logic, CMOS logic, BJT logic, etc. can be used to drive the output to a downstream logic. Examples of the drivers include inverters, buffers, NAND gates, NOR gates, XOR gates, amplifiers, comparators, digital-to-analog converters, analog-to-digital converters, multiplexers, etc.

(189) The majority function is performed at the summing node Vs, and the resulting voltage is projected on to capacitance of driver circuitry **1401**. For example, the majority function of the currents ($I_{\text{sub.a}}$, $I_{\text{sub.b}}$, and $I_{\text{sub.c}}$) on node Vs results in a resultant current that charges capacitor. Table 1 illustrates the majority function f (Majority a, b, c).

(190) TABLE-US-00001 TABLE 1 a b c Vs (f(Majority a, b, c)) 0 0 0 0 0 1 0 0 1 0 0 0 1 1 1 1 0 0 0 1 0 1 1 1 1 0 1 1 1 1 1

(191) The charge developed on node Vs produces a voltage and current that is the output of 3-input majority gate **1400**. Any suitable driver circuitry **1401** can drive this output. For example, a non-FE logic, FE logic, CMOS logic, BJT logic, etc. can be used to drive the output to a downstream logic. Examples of the drivers include inverters, buffers, NAND gates, NOR gates, XOR gates, amplifiers, comparators, digital-to-analog converters, analog-to-digital converters, multiplexers, etc.

(192) While FIG. 14 illustrates a 3-input majority gate, the same concept can be extended to more than 3 inputs to make an N-input majority gate, where N is greater than 2. In various embodiments, 'N' is an odd number. For example, a 5-input majority gate is similar to 3-input input majority gate **1400** but for additional inputs 'd' and 'e'. These inputs can come from the same drivers or from different drivers.

(193) In at least one embodiment, the 3-input majority gate can be configured as a fast inverter with a much faster propagation delay compared to a similar sized (in terms of area footprint) CMOS inverter. This is particularly useful when the inputs have a significantly slower slope compared to the propagation delay through the non-linear input capacitors. One way to configure the 3-input majority gate as an inverter is to set one input to a logic high (e.g., $b=1$) and set another input to a logic low (e.g., $b=0$). The third input is the driving input which is to be inverted. The inversion will be at the V_s node. The same technique can also be applied to N-input majority gate, where 'N' is 1 or any other odd number. In an N-input majority gate, $(N-1)/2$ inputs are set to '1' and $(N-1)/2$ inputs are set to '0', and one input is used to decide the inversion function. The various embodiments are described as a majority gate, the same concepts are applicable to a minority gate. In a minority gate the driving circuitry is an inverting circuitry coupled to the summing node V_s . The minority function is seen at the output of the inverting circuitry.

(194) In at least one embodiment, $(2N-1)$ input majority gate can operate as an N-input AND gate where $(N-1)$ inputs of the majority gate are set to zero. The AND function will be seen at the summing node V_s . Similarly, N-input NAND, OR, NOR gates can be realized. In various embodiments, the summing node V_s is driven by a driver circuitry (e.g., inverter, buffer, NAND gate, AND gate, OR gate, NOR gate, or any other logic circuitry). However, driver circuitry **1401** can be replaced with another majority or minority gate. In one such embodiment, the storage node V_s is directly coupled to a non-linear capacitor of another majority or minority gate.

(195) Any logic function $f(x_{\text{sub}.1}, x_{\text{sub}.2}, \dots, x_{\text{sub}.n})$ can be represented by two levels of logic as given by the min-term expansion: $f(x_{\text{sub}.1}, x_{\text{sub}.2}, \dots, x_{\text{sub}.n}) = V_{C_{\text{sub}.1}, C_{\text{sub}.2}, \dots, C_{\text{sub}.n}} f(x_{\text{sub}.1}, x_{\text{sub}.2}, \dots, x_{\text{sub}.n}) \wedge x_{\text{sub}.1}^{\text{sup}.C_{\text{sub}.1}}$

$\wedge x_{\text{sub}.2}^{\text{sup}.C_{\text{sub}.2}} \wedge x_{\text{sub}.3}^{\text{sup}.C_{\text{sub}.3}} \dots \wedge x_{\text{sub}.n}^{\text{sup}.C_{\text{sub}.n}}$ where C_i is either 0 or 1. When $C_{\text{sub}.i}$ is 1, $x_{\text{sub}.i}^{\text{sup}.C_{\text{sub}.i}} = x_{\text{sub}.i}$ (the input is used in its original form). When $C_{\text{sub}.i}$ is 0, $x_{\text{sub}.i}^{\text{sup}.C_{\text{sub}.i}} = \bar{x}_{\text{sub}.i}$ (the input is used in its inverted form). The first level of logic is represented by at most $2^{\text{sup}.n}$ AND gates (Δ), one for each of the $2^{\text{sup}.n}$ possible combinations of 0 and 1 for $C_{\text{sub}.1}, C_{\text{sub}.2}, \dots, C_{\text{sub}.n}$. The second level of logic is represented by an OR gate (V). Each operand of the OR gate is a representation of a row in the truth table for $f(x_{\text{sub}.1}, x_{\text{sub}.2}, \dots, x_{\text{sub}.n})$.

(196) A $(2N-1)$ -input majority gate can represent an N-input AND gate, by tying $(N-1)$ of the majority gate's inputs to a ground level. Similarly, a $(2N-1)$ -input majority gate can represent an N-input OR gate, by tying $(N-1)$ of the majority gate's inputs to a supply level (V_{dd}). Since a majority gate can represent AND and OR gates, and the inputs to the AND and OR gates are either original or inverted forms of the input digital signals, any logic function can be represented by majority gates and inverters only, in accordance with at least one embodiment.

(197) FIG. 15 illustrates complex logic gate **1500** implemented using a 5-input majority gate, in accordance with at least one embodiment. In at least one embodiment, an AOI (and-or-invert) logic comprises a 5-input majority gate. The 5-input majority gate includes non-linear capacitors C_{1n1} , C_{2n1} , C_{3n1} , C_{4n1} , and C_{5n1} and driving circuitry **1501** coupled as shown. In various embodiments, two of the non-linear capacitors receive the same input. Here, capacitors C_{3n1} and C_{4n1} receive input 'c'. In various embodiments, C_{5n1} is coupled to V_{dd} to produce an OR function at node V_s , where the OR function is $\text{OR}(\text{AND}(a,b),c)$. In at least one embodiment, other logic gates can be realized by changing V_{dd} to ground for capacitor C_{5n1} , and/or changing other inputs.

(198) Following examples are provided that illustrate the various embodiments. The examples can be combined with other examples. As such, various embodiments can be combined with other embodiments without changing the scope of the invention.

(199) An abstract is provided that will allow the reader to ascertain the nature and gist of the technical disclosure. The abstract is submitted with the understanding that it will not be used to limit the scope or meaning of the claims. The following claims are hereby incorporated into the

detailed description, with each claim standing on its own as a separate embodiment.

(200) Example 1: A device comprising: a first region. The first region comprising: a plurality of first conductive interconnects within a first level; a second level above the first level, the second level comprising: a plurality of ferroelectric memory devices, wherein an individual ferroelectric memory device in the plurality of ferroelectric memory devices is above a respective first conductive interconnect in the plurality of first conductive interconnects, and wherein the individual ferroelectric memory device in the plurality of ferroelectric memory devices comprises a first height; an encapsulation layer on a sidewall of the individual ferroelectric memory device in the plurality of ferroelectric memory devices; a via electrode on the individual ferroelectric memory device in the plurality of ferroelectric memory devices, wherein the via electrode comprises a second height; and a second region adjacent to the first region, the second region comprising an interconnect structure, the interconnect structure comprising: one or more second conductive interconnects within the first level; an etch stop layer comprising a dielectric material in the second level; a plurality of metal lines above the etch stop layer, wherein the plurality of metal lines is within the second level, wherein a respective individual metal line in the plurality of metal lines comprises a third height; and a via structure coupling a metal line in the plurality of metal lines with a second conductive interconnect in the one or more second conductive interconnects, wherein the via structure is in the second level and comprises a fourth height, wherein a combined sum of the first height and the second height is equal to a combined sum of the third height and the fourth height.

(201) Example 2: The device of example 1, wherein individual ones of the plurality of first conductive interconnects comprises one or more of copper, cobalt, tungsten, ruthenium, molybdenum, tantalum or titanium and wherein individual ones of the plurality of first conductive interconnects comprises a first lateral thickness.

(202) Example 3: The device of example 2, wherein individual ones of the plurality of first conductive interconnects comprises copper and one or more of titanium or ruthenium, wherein individual ferroelectric memory devices in the plurality of ferroelectric memory devices comprise a respective second lateral thickness, and wherein the second lateral thickness is greater than the first lateral thickness.

(203) Example 4: The device of example 3, wherein the individual ferroelectric memory devices in the plurality of ferroelectric memory devices further extend over portions of a dielectric adjacent to the individual ones of the plurality of first conductive interconnects.

(204) Example 5: The device of example 2, wherein individual ones of the plurality of first conductive interconnects comprises one or more of copper, cobalt, tungsten, ruthenium, molybdenum, tantalum or titanium but not copper, wherein the individual ferroelectric memory devices in the plurality of ferroelectric memory devices comprise a respective second lateral thickness, and wherein the second lateral thickness is less than the first lateral thickness.

(205) Example 6: The device of example 1, wherein the second height is greater than the third height, and wherein the first height is less than the fourth height.

(206) Example 7: The device of example 1, wherein the second height is less than the third height and wherein the first height is greater than the fourth height.

(207) Example 8: The device of example 1, wherein the encapsulation layer comprises a thickness between 5 nm and 30 nm as measured from the sidewall of the individual ones of the plurality of ferroelectric memory devices.

(208) Example 9: The device of example 8, wherein the encapsulation layer comprises an outer sidewall opposite to a sidewall that is adjacent to the sidewall of the individual ones of the plurality of ferroelectric memory devices, and wherein the encapsulation layer laterally extends on a portion of an uppermost surface of a dielectric adjacent to the individual ones of the plurality of first conductive interconnects.

(209) Example 10: The device of example 10, wherein the encapsulation layer laterally extends on

a portion of an uppermost surface of the dielectric by a distance that is at least 25% of the thickness of the encapsulation layer.

(210) Example 11: The device of example 8, wherein the encapsulation layer comprises an outer sidewall opposite to a sidewall that is adjacent to the sidewall of the individual ones of the plurality of ferroelectric memory devices, and wherein the encapsulation layer laterally extends on a surface of the dielectric by a distance that is at least 25% of the thickness of the encapsulation layer, and wherein the surface of the dielectric is lower than an uppermost surface of the dielectric.

(211) Example 12: The device of example 10, wherein the dielectric has a portion comprising a sidewall that is substantially aligned with the sidewall of the individual ones of the plurality of ferroelectric memory devices and wherein the encapsulation layer extends below an uppermost surface of the dielectric and on a portion of a sidewall of the dielectric.

(212) Example 13: The device of example 8, wherein the surface of the dielectric below the uppermost surface is gradually sloped.

(213) Example 14: The device of example 8, wherein the surface of the dielectric below the uppermost surface is substantially planar.

(214) Example 15: The device of example 1, wherein the plurality of ferroelectric memory devices is a first plurality of memory devices, wherein the encapsulation layer is a first encapsulation layer, wherein the via electrode is a first via electrode, wherein the device further comprises: a third plurality of conductive interconnects on a plane behind a plane comprising the first plurality of conductive interconnects; a second plurality of ferroelectric memory devices, wherein an individual ferroelectric memory device in the second plurality of ferroelectric memory devices is above a respective conductive interconnect in the plurality of second conductive interconnects, and wherein the individual ferroelectric memory device in the second plurality of ferroelectric memory devices comprises the first height; a second encapsulation layer on a respective sidewall of the individual ferroelectric memory device in the second plurality of ferroelectric memory devices; and a second via electrode on individual ones of the plurality of ferroelectric memory devices, wherein the second via electrode comprises the second height.

(215) Example 16: The device of example 15, wherein the first encapsulation layer is directly adjacent to the sidewall of a first ferroelectric memory device in the first plurality of memory devices and laterally extends towards and merges with the second encapsulation layer that is directly adjacent to the sidewall of the second ferroelectric memory device in the second plurality of memory devices, where the second ferroelectric memory device is directly behind the first ferroelectric memory device.

(216) Example 17: The device of example 16, wherein the first encapsulation layer or the second encapsulation layer between the first ferroelectric memory device and the second ferroelectric memory device has a lateral thickness that is constant along a direction from the first ferroelectric memory device to the second ferroelectric memory device.

(217) Example 18: The device of example 17, wherein first encapsulation layer and the second encapsulation layer comprise the same material, and wherein the first encapsulation layer adjacent to the first plurality of memory devices and the second encapsulation layer adjacent to the second plurality of memory devices merge over the dielectric.

(218) Example 19: A device comprising a first region. The first region comprising: a trench interconnect extending along a first direction; a second level above the first level, the second level comprising: a plurality of ferroelectric memory devices, wherein individual ferroelectric memory devices in the plurality of ferroelectric memory devices are laterally spaced apart above the trench interconnect; an encapsulation layer on sidewalls of the individual ferroelectric memory devices in the plurality of ferroelectric memory devices; a via electrode on a respective individual ferroelectric memory device in the plurality of ferroelectric memory devices; and a second region adjacent to the first region, the second region comprising an interconnect structure, the interconnect structure comprising: one or more conductive interconnects within the first level; an etch stop layer

comprising a dielectric material in the second level; a plurality of metal lines above the etch stop layer, the plurality of metal lines in the second level; and a via structure coupling a respective metal line in the plurality of metal lines and a conductive interconnect in the one or more conductive interconnects, and wherein an uppermost surface of the via electrode is co-planar with an uppermost surface of the metal lines.

(219) Example 20: The device of example 19, wherein the trench interconnect comprises one or more of copper, cobalt, tungsten, ruthenium, molybdenum, tantalum or titanium, and wherein the trench interconnect comprises a first lateral thickness.

(220) Example 21: The device of example 20, wherein the trench interconnect comprises copper and one or more of titanium or ruthenium, wherein the individual ferroelectric memory devices in the plurality of ferroelectric memory devices comprise a respective second lateral thickness, and wherein the second lateral thickness is greater than the first lateral thickness.

(221) Example 22: The device of example 19, wherein the individual ferroelectric memory devices in the plurality of ferroelectric memory devices further extend over portions of a dielectric adjacent to sidewalls of the trench interconnect.

(222) Example 23: The device of example 19, wherein individual ones of the plurality of first conductive interconnects comprises one or more of cobalt, tungsten, ruthenium, molybdenum, tantalum or titanium but not copper, wherein the individual ferroelectric memory devices in the plurality of ferroelectric memory devices comprise a respective second lateral thickness, and wherein the second lateral thickness is less than the first lateral thickness.

(223) Example 24: A method of fabricating a device structure, the method comprising: forming a plurality of conductive interconnects in a dielectric in a memory region and one or more conductive interconnects in a logic region; depositing an etch stop layer on the dielectric and on the plurality of conductive interconnects and on the one or more conductive interconnects; etching to remove the etch stop layer from a memory region but not from a logic region; depositing an electrode material on the plurality of conductive interconnects in the memory region and on the etch stop layer in the logic region; forming a plurality of memory devices by etching the material layer stack, wherein the etching forms a memory device of the plurality of memory devices above a respective conductive interconnect in the plurality of conductive interconnects in the memory region; depositing an encapsulation layer on the plurality of memory devices; blanket depositing a dielectric layer on the encapsulation layer; forming one or more openings in the dielectric layer and in the encapsulation layer, the one or more openings exposing the one or more conductive interconnects in the logic region; forming an interconnect via in a respective one or more openings and a metal line on a respective interconnect via; forming an opening above a respective memory device in the plurality of memory devices; and filing the opening above the respective memory device in the plurality of memory devices with a conductive material to form a respective via electrode.

(224) Example 25: The method of example 24, wherein the method further comprises: forming a mask on the encapsulation layer, wherein the mask covers a respective memory device in the plurality of memory devices; and etching the encapsulation layer.

(225) Example 26: A device comprising a first region, the first region comprising: a first conductive interconnect within a first level; a second level above the first level, the second level comprising: a ferroelectric memory device comprising a first height and further comprising a cylindrical shape, the ferroelectric memory device above the first conductive interconnect; an encapsulation layer on a sidewall of the ferroelectric memory device; a via electrode on the ferroelectric memory device, wherein the via electrode comprises a second height; and a second region adjacent to the first region, the second region comprising an interconnect structure, the interconnect structure comprising: a second conductive interconnect within the first level; an etch stop layer comprising a dielectric material in the second level; a metal line above the etch stop layer, wherein the metal line is within the second level and wherein the metal line comprises a third height; and a via structure

coupling the metal line with the second conductive interconnect, wherein the via structure is in the second level and comprises a fourth height, wherein a combined sum of the first height and the second height is equal to a combined sum of the third height and the fourth height.

(226) Example 27: The device of example 26, wherein the first conductive interconnect comprises one or more of copper, cobalt, tungsten, ruthenium, molybdenum, tantalum or titanium, wherein the first conductive interconnect comprises a cylindrical profile and wherein the first conductive interconnect comprises a first lateral thickness, wherein the first lateral thickness is a first diameter.

(227) Example 28: The device of example 27, wherein the first conductive interconnect comprises copper and one or more of titanium or ruthenium, wherein the ferroelectric memory device comprises a respective second lateral thickness, wherein the second lateral thickness is a second diameter where the first diameter is less than the second diameter.

(228) Example 29: The device of example 27, wherein the first conductive interconnect comprises one or more of cobalt, tungsten, ruthenium, molybdenum, tantalum or titanium, but not copper, wherein the ferroelectric memory device comprises a respective second lateral thickness, wherein the second lateral thickness is a second diameter where the first diameter is greater than the second diameter.

(229) Example 29: The device of example 27, wherein the first conductive interconnect comprises one or more of cobalt, tungsten, ruthenium, molybdenum, tantalum or titanium, but not copper, wherein the ferroelectric memory device comprises a respective second lateral thickness, wherein the second lateral thickness is a second diameter where the first diameter is less than the second diameter.

(230) Example 30: The device of example 26, wherein the second height is greater than the third height, and wherein the first height is less than the fourth height, and wherein the first height is less than 20 nm and the second height is greater than 50 nm but less than 200 nm.

(231) Example 31: The device of example 26, wherein the ferroelectric memory device is a first memory device, wherein the encapsulation layer is a first encapsulation layer, wherein the via electrode is a first via electrode, wherein the device further comprises: a third conductive interconnect on a plane behind a plane comprising the first conductive interconnect; a second ferroelectric memory device above the third conductive interconnect and wherein the second ferroelectric memory device comprises the first height; a second encapsulation layer on a sidewall of the ferroelectric memory device; and a second via electrode on second ferroelectric memory device, wherein the second via electrode comprises the second height.

(232) Example 32: The device of example 31, wherein the first encapsulation layer and the second encapsulation layer comprise the same material, and wherein the first encapsulation extends along a shortest direction from above the first conductive interconnect to the third conductive interconnect.

(233) Example 33: The device of example 31, wherein the first encapsulation layer is directly adjacent to the sidewall of a first ferroelectric memory device and laterally extends towards and is adjacent to the second encapsulation layer that is directly adjacent to the sidewall of the second ferroelectric memory device, wherein the first encapsulation layer or the second encapsulation layer between the first ferroelectric memory device and the second ferroelectric memory device has a lateral thickness that is constant along a direction from the first ferroelectric memory device to the second ferroelectric memory device, and wherein the lateral thickness is greater than a first diameter of the first ferroelectric memory device or a second diameter of the second ferroelectric memory device by a thickness equivalent to a thickness of the encapsulation layer.

(234) Example 34: The device of example 33, wherein the lateral thickness is greater than a first diameter of the first ferroelectric memory device or a second diameter of the second ferroelectric memory device by a thickness equivalent to a thickness that is at least 25% greater than a thickness of the encapsulation layer.

(235) Example 35: The device of example 31, wherein the first via electrode and the second via electrode are coupled by a plate electrode extending from above the first ferroelectric memory

device to a second ferroelectric memory device, wherein the plate electrode is within the second level.

(236) Example 36: The device of example 26, wherein the first ferroelectric memory device comprises a dielectric hardmask, wherein the via electrode is coupled with the first ferroelectric memory device through an opening in the dielectric hardmask.

(237) Example 37: The device of example 26, wherein the first ferroelectric memory device comprises a conductive hardmask, wherein the via electrode is coupled with the first ferroelectric memory device through the conductive hardmask.

(238) Example 38: The device of example 26, wherein the first ferroelectric memory device comprises a dual layer hardmask comprising a first layer that is conductive and a second layer on the first layer, wherein the second layer is a dielectric, wherein the via electrode is coupled with the second layer through the first layer.

(239) Example 39: The device of example 26, wherein the first ferroelectric memory device comprises sidewalls that are substantially vertical respect to a lowermost surface of the first ferroelectric memory device.

(240) Example 41: The device of example 26, wherein the first ferroelectric memory device comprises sidewalls that have a slope that is different from 90° with respect to a lowermost surface of the first ferroelectric memory device.

(241) Example 42: The device of example 26, wherein the device further comprises portion of one or more layers of the ferroelectric memory device adjacent to a sidewall of etch stop layer at a boundary between the memory region and the logic region.

(242) Example 43: A method of fabricating a device structure, the method comprising: forming a plurality of conductive interconnects in a dielectric in a memory region and one or more conductive interconnects in a logic region; depositing an etch stop layer on the dielectric and on the plurality of conductive interconnects and on the one or more conductive interconnects; etching to remove the etch stop layer from a memory region but not from a logic region; depositing an electrode material on the plurality of conductive interconnects in the memory region and on the etch stop layer in the logic region; forming a plurality of memory devices by etching the material layer stack, wherein the etching forms a memory device of the plurality of memory devices above a respective conductive interconnect in the plurality of conductive interconnects in the memory region; depositing an encapsulation layer on the plurality of memory devices; blanket depositing a dielectric layer on the encapsulation layer; forming one or more first openings in the dielectric layer and in the encapsulation layer, the first one or more openings exposing the one or more conductive interconnects in the logic region and simultaneously forming a second one or more openings in the memory region, the second one or more openings exposing one or more devices in the plurality of memory devices; and forming an interconnect via in a respective first one or more openings and a metal line on a respective interconnect via, and forming a conductive via in the second one or more openings to form a respective via electrode by depositing a conductive material in the first and in the second one or more openings.

(243) Example 44: The method of example 43, wherein the method of depositing the encapsulation layer comprises depositing on a surface of a dielectric layer adjacent to the plurality of conductive interconnects, wherein the surface is tapered relative to a sidewall of an individual memory device in the plurality of memory devices.

(244) Example 45: The method of example 44, wherein the method further comprises depositing a portion of the encapsulation layer on a sidewall of the dielectric layer, wherein the sidewall of the dielectric layer and the sidewall of the individual memory device in the plurality of memory devices is substantially aligned.

(245) Example 46: The method of example 43, wherein the method of forming the interconnect via in a respective first one or more openings further comprises: masking the second one or more openings and a portion of the first one or more openings; forming a second opening within the

portion of the first one or more openings; etching the dielectric exposed by the second opening; and etching the etch stop layer after etching the dielectric, the etching exposing a conductive interconnect in the one or more conductive interconnects in the logic region.

Claims

1. A method of fabricating a device structure, the method comprising: forming a first conductive interconnect in a dielectric in a memory region and a second conductive interconnect in a logic region; depositing an etch stop layer on the dielectric and on the first conductive interconnect and on the second conductive interconnect; etching and removing the etch stop layer from the memory region but not from the logic region; depositing a material layer stack including a non-linear polar material on the first conductive interconnect, on the dielectric, on a sidewall of the etch stop layer, at an interface between the memory region and the logic region and on the etch stop layer; forming a memory device by etching the material layer stack, wherein the etching forms the memory device directly on at least a portion of the first conductive interconnect; depositing an encapsulation layer on the memory device, including on a top surface and on at least a sidewall of the memory device; forming a mask on the encapsulation layer above the memory device; using the mask to etch portions of the encapsulation layer; blanket depositing a dielectric layer; forming a first opening in the dielectric layer, the first opening exposing the second conductive interconnect in the logic region; forming an interconnect via in the first opening and a metal line on the interconnect via by depositing a conductive material in the first opening; forming a second opening in the dielectric layer and in the encapsulation layer, the second opening exposing the memory device; and forming a via electrode in the second opening by depositing the conductive material in the second opening.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the non-linear polar material comprises one of: bismuth ferrite (BFO) or BFO with a first doping material, wherein the first doping material is one of lanthanum or elements from lanthanide series of periodic table; lead zirconium titanate (PZT) or PZT with a second doping material, wherein the second doping material is one of La or Nb; a relaxor ferroelectric material which includes one of: lead magnesium niobate (PMN), lead magnesium niobate-lead titanate (PMN-PT), lead lanthanum zirconate titanate (PLZT), lead scandium niobate (PSN), barium titanium-bismuth zinc niobium tantalum (BT-BZNT), or barium titanium-barium strontium titanium (BT-BST); a perovskite material which includes one of: $\text{BaTiO}_{3.0}$, $\text{PbTiO}_{3.0}$, $\text{KNbO}_{3.0}$, or $\text{NaTaO}_{3.0}$; a hexagonal ferroelectric which includes one of: $\text{YMnO}_{3.0}$, or $\text{LuFeO}_{3.0}$; hexagonal ferroelectrics of a type $\text{h-RMnO}_{3.0}$, where R is a rare earth element which includes one of: cerium (Ce), dysprosium (Dy), erbium (Er), europium (Eu), gadolinium (Gd), holmium (Ho), lanthanum (La), lutetium (Lu), neodymium (Nd), praseodymium (Pr), promethium (Pm), samarium (Sm), scandium (Sc), terbium (Tb), thulium (Tm), ytterbium (Yb), or yttrium (Y); hafnium (Hf), zirconium (Zr), aluminum (Al), silicon (Si), their oxides, or their alloyed oxides; hafnium oxides as $\text{Hf}_{1-x}\text{E}_x\text{O}_y$, where E can be Al, Ca, Ce, Dy, Er, Gd, Ge, La, Sc, Si, Sr, Sn, Zr, or Y, where x and y are first and second fractions, respectively; $\text{Al}_{1-x}\text{Sc}_x\text{N}$, $\text{Ga}_{1-x}\text{Sc}_x\text{N}$, $\text{Al}_{1-x}\text{Y}_x\text{N}$ or $\text{Al}_{1-x-y}\text{Mg}_x\text{Nb}_y\text{N}$, where x and y are third and fourth fractions, respectively; doped $\text{HfO}_{2.0}$; niobate type compounds $\text{LiNbO}_{3.0}$, $\text{LiTaO}_{3.0}$, lithium iron tantalum oxy fluoride, barium strontium niobate, sodium barium niobate, or potassium strontium niobate; an improper ferroelectric material which includes one of: $[\text{PTO}/\text{STO}]_n$ or $[\text{LAO}/\text{STO}]_n$, where 'n' is between 1 and 100; or $\text{SrTiO}_{3.0}$, $\text{Ba}_{1-x}\text{Sr}_x\text{TiO}_{3.0}$, $\text{HfZrO}_{2.0}$, Hf-Si-O , La-substituted $\text{PbTiO}_{3.0}$, or a PMN-PT based relaxor ferroelectric; and wherein etching the material layer stack forms a spacer of the material layer stack adjacent to the sidewall of the etch stop layer.
3. The method of claim 2, wherein etching the material layer stack to form the memory device further comprises: forming the memory device on a portion of the dielectric; and etching and recessing the dielectric adjacent to the memory device, wherein recessing forms a dielectric surface

below a lowermost surface of the memory device, and a dielectric sidewall that is substantially aligned with the sidewall of the memory device.

4. The method of claim 3, wherein forming the encapsulation layer further comprises depositing the encapsulation layer on the dielectric sidewall and on the dielectric surface.

5. The method of claim 2, wherein depositing the encapsulation layer further comprises depositing on the spacer of the material layer stack.

6. The method of claim 5, wherein forming the mask further comprises forming the mask on the encapsulation layer deposited on the spacer of the material layer stack, and wherein patterning the encapsulation layer further comprises etching and removing the encapsulation layer from above the etch stop layer and leaving a third portion of the encapsulation layer on the spacer of the material layer stack and on a surface of the dielectric.

7. The method of claim 6, wherein the memory device is a first memory device, wherein the via electrode is a first via electrode, wherein etching the material layer stack forms a second memory device above a third conductive interconnect, the third conductive interconnect laterally formed in the dielectric on a plane that is laterally distant from the plane of the first conductive interconnect, and wherein the method further comprises: forming a second via electrode on the second memory device; and forming a plate electrode extending from above first via electrode to above the second via electrode.

8. The method of claim 1, wherein the mask comprises a first lateral thickness that is at least equal to a second lateral thickness of the memory device and two times a third lateral thickness of the encapsulation layer.

9. The method of claim 8, wherein the first lateral thickness is greater than the second lateral thickness and two times the third lateral thickness, and wherein etching the encapsulation layer further comprises: forming a patterned encapsulation layer comprising: a first portion on the memory device; a second portion adjacent to sidewalls of the memory device, the second portion comprising a fourth lateral thickness; and a lateral extension adjacent to the second portion, the lateral extension on a third portion of the dielectric.

10. The method of claim 8, wherein the first lateral thickness is substantially equal to the second lateral thickness and two times the third lateral thickness, and wherein etching the encapsulation layer adjacent to the memory device comprises forming a patterned encapsulation layer having a substantially uniform lateral thickness and an outermost encapsulation layer sidewall.

11. The method of claim 1, wherein the method of forming the first opening further comprises: performing a plasma etch process to form a hanging trench above the second conductive interconnect; forming a via mask within the hanging trench, the via mask comprising a third opening; and forming a fourth opening by etching the dielectric layer exposed by the third opening and by etching the etch stop layer after etching the dielectric layer, the etching exposing the second conductive interconnect.

12. The method of claim 11, wherein forming the metal line and the interconnect via comprises: simultaneously depositing the conductive material in the hanging trench and in the fourth opening and on the dielectric layer; and planarizing the conductive material from above the dielectric layer to isolate the conductive material in the hanging trench and in the fourth opening.

13. A method of fabricating a device structure, the method comprising: forming a first conductive interconnect in a dielectric in a memory region and a second conductive interconnect in a logic region; depositing an etch stop layer on the dielectric and on the first conductive interconnect and on the second conductive interconnect; etching and removing the etch stop layer from the memory region but not from the logic region; depositing a material layer stack including ferroelectric or paraelectric material on the first conductive interconnect, on the dielectric, and on the etch stop layer; forming a memory device by etching the material layer stack, wherein the etching forms the memory device directly on at least a portion of the first conductive interconnect; depositing an encapsulation layer on the memory device, including on a top surface and on at least a sidewall of

the memory device; forming a first mask on the encapsulation layer above the memory device; using the first mask to etch portions of the encapsulation layer; blanket depositing a dielectric layer; forming a hanging trench in the dielectric layer over the second conductive interconnect by etching the dielectric layer and simultaneously forming a first opening to expose the memory device, wherein the first opening is formed by etching the dielectric layer and the encapsulation layer above the memory device; forming a second mask within the hanging trench and in the first opening, the second mask comprising a second opening within the hanging trench; forming a third opening by etching the dielectric layer exposed by the second opening and by etching the etch stop layer after etching the dielectric layer, the etching exposing the second conductive interconnect; removing the second mask and simultaneously depositing a conductive material in the first opening, in the third opening and in the hanging trench and on the dielectric layer; and planarizing the conductive material to simultaneously form a via electrode on the memory device, a via interconnect in the third opening and a metal line in the hanging trench.

14. The method of claim 13, wherein etching comprises utilizing a plasma etch process and forming the hanging trench and the first opening further comprises: halting the plasma etch process after the encapsulation layer is exposed in the memory region; and continuing the plasma etch process to remove the encapsulation layer from above the memory device.

15. The method of claim 13, wherein etching the encapsulation layer to form the first opening recesses the hanging trench below a level of an uppermost surface of the memory device.

16. A method of fabricating a device structure, the method comprising: forming a first trench interconnect in a dielectric in a memory region and a second trench interconnect in a logic region; depositing an etch stop layer on the dielectric and on the first trench interconnect and on the second trench interconnect; etching to remove the etch stop layer from the memory region but not from the logic region; depositing a material layer stack including ferroelectric or paraelectric material on the first trench interconnect, on the dielectric, and on the etch stop layer; forming a memory device by etching the material layer stack, wherein the etching forms the memory device directly above the first trench interconnect; depositing an encapsulation layer on the memory device, including on a top surface and on at least a sidewall of the memory device; forming a mask on the encapsulation layer above the memory device; using the mask to etch portions of the encapsulation layer; blanket depositing a dielectric layer; forming a first opening in the dielectric layer and in the encapsulation layer above the memory device and simultaneously forming a second opening in the dielectric layer above the second trench interconnect; completely masking the first opening and partially masking the second opening to form a via opening within the second opening; etching the dielectric layer through the via opening and exposing the second trench interconnect; and forming a via electrode in the first opening, a via structure in the via opening and a metal line in the second opening by depositing a conductive material in the first opening, in the via opening and in the second opening.

17. The method of claim 16, wherein the mask covers a portion of the encapsulation layer that is above the dielectric adjacent to the first trench interconnect.

18. The method of claim 16, wherein the memory device is a first memory device, wherein the first memory device is above a first portion of the first trench interconnect, and wherein etching the material layer stack forms a second memory device above a second portion of the first trench interconnect, the second portion laterally distant from the first portion.

19. The method of claim 18, wherein using the mask to etch the portions of the encapsulation layer forms the encapsulation layer around sidewalls of the first memory device and the second memory device, and wherein the encapsulation layer extends parallel to the first trench interconnect.
